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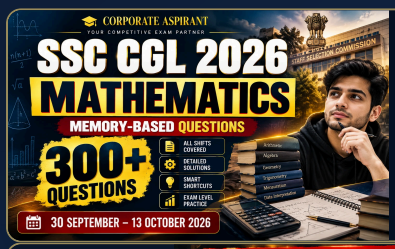
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30 September 2026	QUESTION SET ↗
1 October 2026	QUESTION SET ↗
1 October 2026 — Shift 3	SHIFT SET ↗
5 October 2026	QUESTION SET ↗
6 October 2026	QUESTION SET ↗
7 October 2026	QUESTION SET ↗
8 October 2026	QUESTION SET ↗
9 October 2026	QUESTION SET ↗
10 October 2026	QUESTION SET ↗

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DATE **30 September 2026**

Q1. **Select the correct meaning of the idiom "To beard the lion in his den."**

(A) To confront a powerful adversary boldly on their own territory

(B) To make a futile attempt at subduing a ferocious opponent

(C) To seek refuge from a superior enemy

(D) To incite unnecessary conflict with an authority

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) To confront a powerful adversary boldly on their own territory**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The idiom means to confront a powerful or dangerous person directly in their own territory, despite the risks involved.

RELATED IDIOMS FOR SSC CGL:

Take the bull by the horns — Face a difficult situation directly.

Bell the cat — Undertake a risky task.

Throw down the gauntlet — Issue a challenge.

Face the music — Accept the consequences of one's actions.

Q2. **Select the sentence containing the intended homonym of the highlighted word "bank."**

The bank approved her loan application without delay.

(A) The children played on the grassy bank beside the river.

(B) The bank interest rates were revised this quarter.

(C) She approached the bank manager for financial advice.

(D) The bank's new branch opened in the city centre.

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) The children played on the grassy bank beside the river.**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

In the original sentence, bank refers to a financial institution. In option (A), it refers to the land beside a river. The spelling is the same, but the meanings differ.

MORE EXAMPLES:

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Bat — A flying mammal; a piece of sports equipment.

Match — A contest; a small stick used to produce fire.

Bark — The outer covering of a tree; the sound made by a dog.

EXAM NOTE These are often taught as homonyms in competitive-exam questions; in stricter linguistics, some such examples are classified as polysemy.

Q3. Choose the most appropriate conversion into Direct Speech.

The engineer pointed out that, by the time the backup system activated, the damage would already have been done.

(A) The engineer pointed out, "By the time the backup system activates, the damage will already have been done."

(B) The engineer said, "By the time the backup system is activated, the damage will already be done."

(C) The engineer pointed out, "By the time the backup system activated, the damage had already been done."

(D) The engineer said, "By the time the backup system was activated, the damage would have already been done."

✓ **Correct Answer: (A)**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

When indirect speech is converted back into direct speech, the original tense sequence is restored. Here, would changes to will, and activated returns to activates in the time clause.

EXAM RULE In reported speech, will commonly changes to would and present simple to past simple when backshift is required.

EXAMPLE

Example: He said, “I work hard.” → He said that he worked hard.

Q4. Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Supercilious

(B) Supercilous

(C) Supercillious

(D) Supercillous

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) Supercilious**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Supercilious means behaving as though one is superior to others; arrogant or disdainful.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Arrogant — Having an exaggerated sense of one's importance.

Haughty — Showing superiority or disdain.

Condescending — Treating others as inferior.

Humble — Not arrogant or excessively proud.

Q5. **Choose the correct one-word substitute for "A mild or indirect expression substituted for one that might be considered too harsh or blunt when referring to something unpleasant."**

(A) Aphorism

(B) Hyperbole

(C) Euphemism

(D) Epithet

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Euphemism**

✦ EXPLANATION

A euphemism is a polite or indirect expression used instead of one that may sound harsh or offensive.

EXAMPLES:

Passed away — Instead of died.

Let go — Instead of dismissed from employment.

Economical with the truth — A tactful way of implying dishonesty.

IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS:

Aphorism — A short statement expressing a general truth.

Hyperbole — Deliberate exaggeration.

Epithet — A descriptive word or phrase associated with a person or thing.

Passage: Workplace Stress

In contemporary professional environments, workplace stress has emerged as a pervasive and insidious phenomenon, often undermining both organizational efficiency and employee well-being. Far from being a mere by-product of demanding schedules, chronic occupational stress is frequently rooted in deeper systemic issues such as unrealistic expectations, inadequate support structures, and a pervasive culture of constant connectivity. The relentless pursuit of productivity, amplified by technological advancements that blur the boundaries between personal and professional spheres, has exacerbated

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Left unchecked, prolonged exposure to high-stress environments can precipitate a range of deleterious outcomes, including burnout, diminished cognitive functioning, and even serious physical health conditions like hypertension and cardiovascular disease. Organizations that fail to recognize and address the underlying causes of stress not only risk elevated turnover rates but also compromise innovation, morale, and overall competitiveness.

Counteracting workplace stress demands a multifaceted approach that transcends superficial interventions such as temporary wellness programs or occasional mindfulness workshops. Instead, it requires a fundamental re-evaluation of work design, leadership styles, and organizational priorities. Encouraging open dialogue about mental health, instituting flexible work arrangements, and fostering a culture that genuinely values work-life balance are pivotal steps toward cultivating a more sustainable and humane professional landscape.

Q6. **Identify the tense used in the sentence:**

"Left unchecked, prolonged exposure to high-stress environments can precipitate a range of deleterious outcomes."

(A) Past Perfect

(B) Present Simple

(C) Future Perfect

(D) Present Conditional

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Present Simple**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The sentence expresses a general fact or possibility. Strictly speaking, can precipitate is a modal verb construction expressing general possibility, rather than the plain present-simple form.

EXAM RULE General truths commonly use the present simple: "Excessive stress affects productivity."

Q7. **Identify the grammatical function of "Far from being a mere by-product of demanding schedules" in the first paragraph.**

(A) It is the main subject of the sentence.

(B) It is an introductory phrase modifying the main clause.

(C) It is a dependent clause providing a condition.

(D) It is a direct object of the verb.

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) It is an introductory phrase modifying the main clause.**

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✦ EXPLANATION

The phrase introduces a contrast to the idea that workplace stress is merely caused by demanding schedules. It is a phrase, not a complete dependent clause, because it lacks a finite verb.

EXAM TIP A phrase does not contain a complete subject–finite-verb structure; a clause generally does.

Q8. **What is the meaning of “insidious” as used in the passage?**

(A) Open and obvious

(B) Harmless and fleeting

(C) Gradually harmful and subtle

(D) Quickly destructive and visible

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Gradually harmful and subtle**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Insidious describes something harmful that develops gradually or operates in a subtle way, often without being noticed immediately.

Synonyms: Sly, stealthy, subtle, treacherous, pernicious.

Antonyms: Obvious, harmless, benign, overt.

EXAMPLE

Example: The insidious effects of misinformation can weaken public trust over time.

Q9. **The word “deleterious” most nearly means:**

(A) Advantageous

(B) Harmful

(C) Temporary

(D) Curious

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Harmful**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Deleterious means causing harm or damage, particularly to health or well-being.

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Antonyms: Beneficial, advantageous, salutary, favourable.

EXAMPLE

Example: Smoking has deleterious effects on cardiovascular health.

Q10. **According to the passage, what is a key failure of organizations when addressing workplace stress?**

(A) They overly emphasize work-life balance.

(B) They rely on short-term or surface-level solutions.

(C) They provide excessive flexibility, causing laziness.

(D) They hire too many inexperienced employees.

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) They rely on short-term or surface-level solutions.**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The passage argues that temporary wellness programmes and occasional mindfulness workshops are insufficient. Organizations must address structural causes such as unrealistic expectations, inadequate support, leadership practices, and work design.

EXAM TIP For passage-based questions, select the option directly supported by the text. Do not infer claims that the author has not made.

Q11. **Choose the correct passive voice of the following sentence.**

The English teacher was instructing his trainees that they should write the sentences clearly on the notebook.

(A) His trainees were instructed by the English teacher that the sentences should be written clearly on the notebook by them.

(B) His trainees were being instructed by the English teacher that the sentences be written clearly on the notebook by them.

(C) His trainees were being instructed by the English teacher that the sentences should be written clearly on the notebook by them.

(D) His trainees are being instructed by the English teacher that the sentences would be written clearly on the notebook by them.

✓ **Correct Answer: (C)**

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EXPLANATION

The active sentence uses the past continuous tense (was instructing). Its passive equivalent is were being instructed. The clause with should write becomes should be written.

EXAM RULE

Active: Subject + was/were + verb-ing + object.

Passive: Object + was/were + being + past participle.

EXAMPLE

Example: They were repairing the road. → The road was being repaired by them.

Q12. Select the correct option.

The principal investigator insisted ___ conducting a peer-reviewed replication prior to dissemination.

(A) at

(B) with

(C) on

(D) for

Correct Answer: (C) on

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EXPLANATION

The correct construction is insist on + noun/gerund. Since conducting is a gerund here, on is required.

More important preposition rules:

Insist on doing something.

Accuse someone of something.

Abstain from doing something.

Prevent someone from doing something.

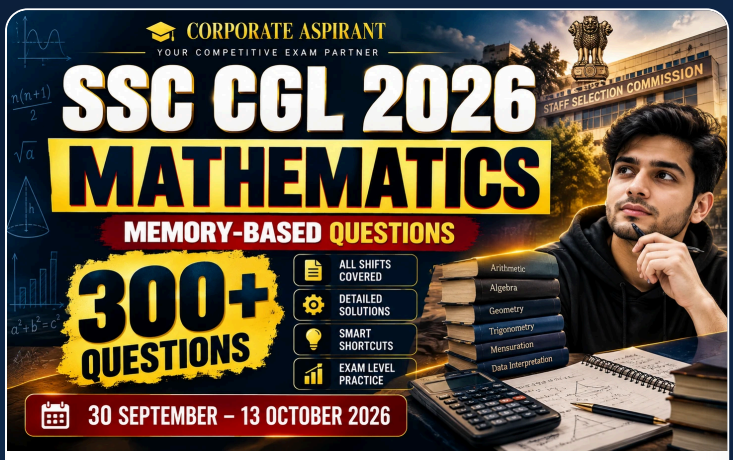
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Q13. **Select the most appropriate antonym of "Incipient."**

(A) Embryonic

(B) Rudimentary

(C) Germinal

(D) Mature

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) Mature**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Incipient means beginning to develop or just starting to appear. Mature indicates a fully developed state.

Synonyms of incipient: Nascent, embryonic, rudimentary, emerging, inchoate.

Antonyms: Mature, developed, established, advanced.

EXAMPLE

Example: The incipient stages of a disease may produce few noticeable symptoms.

Q14. **Select the option that expresses the sentence in active voice.**

The vaccine is said to have been developed by a team of Indian researchers long before the pandemic began.

(A) People say that a team of Indian researchers develops the vaccine long before the pandemic began.

(B) People say that a team of Indian researchers had developed the vaccine long before the pandemic began.

(C) It says that a team of Indian researchers has been developing the vaccine long before the pandemic began.

(D) People said that a team of Indian researchers have developed the vaccine long before the pandemic began.

✓ **Correct Answer: (B)**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

The passive construction is said to have been developed is converted into the active construction people say that ... had developed. The past perfect indicates that development preceded the pandemic.

EXAM RULE

In passive constructions of the form is/are said to have been + past participle, an active equivalent often uses people say that + subject + had + past participle when a completed earlier past event is intended.

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EXAMPLE

Example: He is believed to have won the race. → People believe that he had won the race.

Q15. Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Logorrhhea

(B) Logorrhoa

(C) Logorrhea

(D) Logorrrhea

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Logorrhea**

✦ EXPLANATION

Logorrhea is the American English spelling of a tendency towards excessive, often incessant speech or wordiness. The British English variant is logorrhoea.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Garrulous — Excessively talkative.

Loquacious — Very talkative.

Taciturn — Habitually reserved or uncommunicative.

Reticent — Reluctant to speak freely.

Q16. Find the part of the sentence that contains an error.

The speed with which the markets collapsed (1)/ caught not only the regulators but also the investors (2)/ off guard who had been predicting (3)/ a period of sustained growth. (4)

(A) (1)

(B) (2)

(C) (3)

(D) (4)

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) (3)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The relative clause who had been predicting a period of sustained growth should be placed immediately after the investors, the noun it describes. The original sentence separates the noun from its relative clause.

Corrected sentence: The speed with which the markets collapsed caught not only the regulators but also the investors who had been predicting a period of sustained growth off guard.

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EXAM RULE Place a relative clause close to the noun or pronoun it modifies.

Q17. Choose the correct phrasal verb.

The organising committee decided to _____ the annual conference due to unforeseen circumstances.

(A) put off

(B) put on

(C) put up

(D) put by

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) put off**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Put off means to postpone or delay an event.

Other important phrasal verbs:

Put on — Wear clothing or organise a performance.

Put up with — Tolerate.

Put aside — Save or reserve something.

Put forward — Propose an idea.

Call off — Cancel an event.

Carry out — Execute or perform a task.

Q18. Choose the correct indirect narration.

Sairam said, "She has to come to Delhi to me within the next couple of hours to take help to solve the problem she mentioned."

(A) Sairam said that she had to come to Delhi to her within the following couple of hours to take help to solve the problem she had mentioned.

(B) Sairam said that she had to go to Delhi to him within the next couple of hours to bring help to solve the problem she had mentioned.

(C) Sairam said that she has to go to Delhi to him within the next couple of hours to take help to solve the problem she mentioned.

(D) Sairam said that she had to go to Delhi to him within the following couple of hours to take help to solve the problem she had mentioned.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (D)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The expected changes are come → go when the destination is viewed from the reporter's perspective, has to → had to under backshift, next → following, and mentioned → had mentioned.

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Q19. **Select the correctly spelt word.**

(A) Equanimety

(B) Equanimnity

(C) Equaniminity

(D) Equanimity

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) Equanimity**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Equanimity means mental calmness and composure, especially in a difficult situation.

Synonyms: Composure, poise, serenity, tranquillity, self-possession.

Antonyms: Agitation, anxiety, agitation, perturbation.

EXAMPLE

Example: She handled the unexpected criticism with equanimity.

Q20. **Select the most appropriate synonym of "Excoriate."**

(A) Praise

(B) Condemn

(C) Encourage

(D) Appreciate

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Condemn**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Excoriate means to criticise or denounce someone or something severely.

Synonyms: Condemn, censure, denounce, berate, castigate, lambaste.

Antonyms: Praise, commend, applaud, extol, laud.

EXAMPLE

Example: The committee excoriated the officials for their negligence.

Q21. **Identify the error and select the corrected sentence.**

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(A) By the time we have arrived, the film had already started.

(B) By the time we arrived, the film had already started.

(C) By the time we arrived, the film have already started.

(D) By the time we will arrive, the film has already started.

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) By the time we arrived, the film had already started.**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Both events occurred in the past, but the film started before we arrived. Therefore, the earlier event takes the past perfect (had started), while the later event takes the simple past (arrived).

EXAM RULE Earlier past event = past perfect; later past event = simple past.

EXAMPLE

Example: When I reached the station, the train had left.

Q22. **Select the option that expresses the sentence in passive voice.**

Who vandalised the marble plaques that adorn the memorial's eastern colonnade?

(A) Who were the marble plaques that adorn the memorial's eastern colonnade vandalised by?

(B) By whom the marble plaques that adorn the memorial's eastern colonnade were vandalised?

(C) By whom were the marble plaques that adorn the memorial's eastern colonnade vandalised?

(D) Whom were the marble plaques that adorn the memorial's eastern colonnade vandalised by?

✓ **Correct Answer: (C)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The object the marble plaques becomes the subject of the passive construction. In a formal passive question, Who vandalised...? changes to By whom were ... vandalised?

EXAM RULE For a simple past interrogative in passive voice, use Wh-word + was/were + subject + past participle.

EXAMPLE

Example: Who wrote this letter? → By whom was this letter written?

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Q23. **Find the part of the sentence that contains an error.**

The merger was announced so abruptly (1)/ that it shocked not only the board members (2)/ but also to the investors (3)/ who had been expecting a gradual transition. (4)

(A) (1)

(B) (2)

(C) (3)

(D) (4)

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) (3)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The construction not only ... but also requires parallel grammatical elements. The preposition to is unnecessary before the investors.

Correct sentence: The merger was announced so abruptly that it shocked not only the board members but also the investors who had been expecting a gradual transition.

EXAM TIP In correlative conjunctions, maintain parallel structure: not only X but also Y.

Q24. **Select the most appropriate antonym of "Impecunious."**

(A) Destitute

(B) Opulent

(C) Bankrupt

(D) Penurious

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Opulent**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Impecunious means having little or no money. Opulent means wealthy, rich, or luxurious.

Synonyms of impecunious: Penniless, destitute, impoverished, indigent, penurious.

Antonyms: Wealthy, affluent, prosperous, opulent, well-to-do.

EXAMPLE

Example: The impecunious student relied on a scholarship to continue his studies.

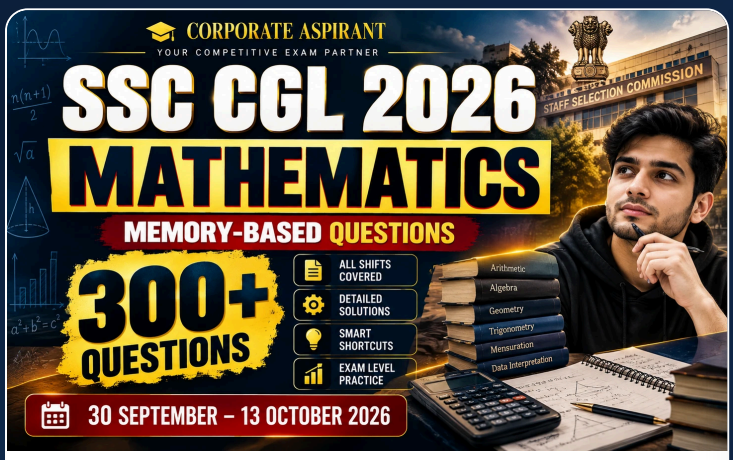
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Q25. **Select the correct meaning of the idiom used in the sentence.**

Despite the challenges, Priya managed to keep her head above water.

(A) To remain calm in a stressful situation

(B) To avoid asking for help

(C) To barely manage to survive or cope

(D) To keep quiet during arguments

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) To barely manage to survive or cope**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Keep one's head above water means to manage a difficult situation, especially financial or practical difficulties, without being overwhelmed.

RELATED IDIOMS FOR SSC CGL:

At the end of one's tether — Having no patience or strength left.

In dire straits — In a very difficult situation.

Make ends meet — Manage expenses with available income.

Weather the storm — Survive a difficult period.

Out of the woods — Free from danger or difficulty.

✦ Quick Revision: Important Vocabulary from Questions 76–100

Meaning and associated vocabulary

Supercilious

MEANING
Arrogant
SYNONYM / ANTONYM
Haughty

Euphemism

MEANING
Polite indirect expression
SYNONYM / ANTONYM
—

Insidious

MEANING
Subtly harmful
SYNONYM / ANTONYM
Pernicious

Deleterious

MEANING
Harmful
SYNONYM / ANTONYM
Detrimental

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Incipient

MEANING

Beginning

SYNONYM / ANTONYM

Antonym: Mature

Logorrhea

MEANING

Excessive speech

SYNONYM / ANTONYM

Loquacity

Equanimity

MEANING

Mental calmness

SYNONYM / ANTONYM

Composure

Excoriate

MEANING

Criticise severely

SYNONYM / ANTONYM

Castigate

Impecunious

MEANING

Having little money

SYNONYM / ANTONYM

Antonym: Opulent

DATE 1 October 2026

1st oct

Q1. **Choose the correct one-word substitute for: "A person who is skilled in many areas."**

(A) Autodidact

(B) Dilettante

(C) Luminary

(D) Polymath

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) Polymath**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

A polymath is a person with extensive knowledge or expertise in several different fields.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Autodidact: A person who teaches themselves.

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Versatile: Capable of performing many different tasks.

Reading Comprehension: Questions 77–81

Passage: Sleep and Cognitive Performance

The relationship between sleep and cognitive performance has become a focal point of neurological research, with mounting evidence suggesting that sleep deprivation exerts a far more pervasive influence on mental functioning than previously acknowledged. Beyond the well-documented effects on alertness and reaction time, chronic sleep insufficiency has been shown to impair higher-order executive functions, including working memory, decision-making, and the capacity for abstract reasoning. These impairments do not manifest as sudden breakdowns but instead accumulate imperceptibly over time, rendering individuals progressively less capable without their awareness—a particularly treacherous dimension of prolonged sleep debt.

At the neurological level, sleep serves as a critical period of cellular restoration and synaptic consolidation. During non-REM sleep, the glymphatic system actively clears metabolic waste products from the brain, including amyloid-beta proteins associated with neurodegenerative conditions. Disruption of this process through habitual short sleep has been tentatively linked to elevated long-term risk of cognitive decline. Simultaneously, REM sleep is integral to emotional regulation and the consolidation of procedural and declarative memory—processes that cannot be compensated for by mere wakefulness.

Despite the compelling scientific consensus surrounding sleep's restorative function, modern professional culture continues to valorise overwork and dismiss sleep as a concession to weakness. Addressing this cultural inertia requires not only individual behavioural change but also systemic institutional reform: workplaces must actively discourage practices that incentivise sleep deprivation, while public health campaigns should endeavour to reframe adequate sleep as a cornerstone of productivity and cognitive wellbeing rather than a sign of insufficient ambition.

Q2. **Which of the following is the correct tense used in the sentence below?**

"Disruption of this process through habitual short sleep has been tentatively linked to elevated long-term risk of cognitive decline."

(A) Simple Past

(B) Present Perfect Passive

(C) Future Continuous

(D) Past Perfect Continuous

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Present Perfect Passive**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

The structure is has/have + been + past participle. Here, "has been linked" indicates a connection established in the past that remains relevant in the present.

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EXAMPLE

Example: The report has been submitted by the officer.

Q3. **Identify the grammatical function of the phrase "Beyond the well-documented effects on alertness and reaction time" in the first paragraph.**

(A) A noun clause functioning as the main subject of the sentence.

(B) A relative clause modifying the noun "evidence".

(C) An introductory prepositional phrase modifying the main clause.

(D) A direct object of the verb "suggested".

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✓ **Correct Answer: (C) An introductory prepositional phrase modifying the main clause**

✦ EXPLANATION

The phrase begins with the preposition "beyond" and introduces additional information about the effects of sleep deprivation. It is a prepositional phrase, not a clause.

EXAM TIP

A prepositional phrase typically begins with a preposition and ends with its object, often a noun or pronoun.

Examples: Under the table, beyond the boundary, after the meeting.

Q4. **What is the meaning of "imperceptibly" as used in the passage?**

(A) Rapidly and measurably

(B) Predictably and systematically

(C) In a manner too gradual to be noticed

(D) Openly and with full awareness

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✓ **Correct Answer: (C) In a manner too gradual to be noticed**

✦ EXPLANATION

Imperceptibly means so gradually or subtly that something cannot easily be noticed.

Synonyms: Unnoticeably, subtly, indistinguishably, inconspicuously.

Antonyms: Noticeably, visibly, perceptibly, conspicuously.

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EXAMPLE

Example: The temperature rose imperceptibly throughout the afternoon.

Q5. **The word "valorise" most nearly means:**

(A) Condemn

(B) Elevate in status or worth

(C) Ignore

(D) Estimate at a low rate

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Elevate in status or worth**

✦ EXPLANATION

Valorise means to assign, enhance, or recognise value or importance. In the passage, it means that professional culture gives excessive importance to overwork.

Synonyms: Esteem, value, appreciate, elevate, glorify.

Antonyms: Devalue, depreciate, disparage, belittle.

EXAMPLE

Example: The institution seeks to valorise traditional knowledge.

Q6. **According to the passage, what makes prolonged sleep debt particularly treacherous?**

(A) It causes immediate and catastrophic neurological failure.

(B) Individuals become progressively less capable without realising it.

(C) It permanently destroys the glymphatic system.

(D) It prevents all forms of memory consolidation within a single night.

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Individuals become progressively less capable without realising it.**

✦ EXPLANATION

The passage states that the effects of sleep deprivation accumulate gradually, reducing cognitive abilities without individuals necessarily recognising the decline.

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EXAM TIP

In comprehension questions, choose the option directly supported by the passage. Avoid extreme statements such as “permanently destroys” unless the passage explicitly supports them.

Q7. **Choose the most suitable preposition to fill in the blank.**

We should always be grateful _____ those who help us.

(A) With

(B) From

(C) Of

(D) To

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) To**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The standard construction is grateful to someone and grateful for something.

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EXAMPLES:

I am grateful to my teacher for her guidance.

We are grateful for your support.

Important Exam Rules:

Kind to someone.

Proud of someone or something.

Interested in something.

Responsible for something.

Prefer one thing to another.

Q8. **Fill in the blank with the correctly spelt word.**

The scientist was known for her _____ adherence to ethical standards.

(A) Unasssailable

(B) Unassailable

(C) Unasailable

(D) Unassailible

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Unassailable**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Unassailable means impossible to attack, challenge, or question successfully. In this sentence, it refers to an adherence to ethical standards that cannot reasonably be challenged.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Indisputable — Impossible to deny or dispute.

Irrefutable — Impossible to prove false.

Incontrovertible — Not open to dispute.

Defensible — Capable of being justified.

Q9. Convert the following sentence from passive voice to active voice.

The patients were being monitored closely by the duty nurse.

(A) The duty nurse has monitored the patients closely.

(B) The duty nurse was monitoring the patients closely.

(C) The duty nurse had been monitoring the patients closely.

(D) The duty nurse monitors the patients closely.

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) The duty nurse was monitoring the patients closely.**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

The passive sentence is in the past continuous tense. Its active equivalent is also in the past continuous tense.

Rule:

Passive: Object + was/were + being + past participle.

Active: Subject + was/were + verb-ing + object.

EXAMPLE

Example: The road was being repaired by the workers. → The workers were repairing the road.

Q10. Change the following sentence from active to passive voice.

They should be reviewing the departmental expenditure reports this month.

(A) The departmental expenditure reports should have been reviewed by them this month.

(B) The departmental expenditure reports are being reviewed by them this month.

(C) The departmental expenditure reports should be being reviewed by them this month.

(D) The departmental expenditure reports should be reviewed by them this month.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (C) The departmental expenditure reports should be being reviewed by them this month.**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The given active sentence uses a modal verb followed by the continuous form: should be reviewing. The corresponding passive construction is should be being + past participle.

Rule: Modal + be + verb-ing changes to modal + be + being + past participle in the passive voice.

EXAMPLE

Example: They should be examining the documents. → The documents should be being examined by them.

EXAM NOTE

Although grammatically possible, this passive construction is awkward and uncommon in everyday English. In an examination, preserve the tense and aspect of the original sentence.

Q11. **Select the most appropriate meaning of the idiom "Hit the purple patch".**

(A) To experience a period of great success or achievement

(B) To face an unexpected period of failure

(C) To become extremely angry over a minor issue

(D) To withdraw from a difficult situation

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) To experience a period of great success or achievement**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

To hit a purple patch means to enter a period of exceptional success, performance, or good fortune.

Related Idioms:

On a roll — Experiencing continued success.

Strike gold — Discover or achieve something valuable.

In full swing — At the peak of activity.

Hit the jackpot — Achieve a highly favourable outcome.

EXAMPLE

Example: The team hit a purple patch and won five consecutive matches.

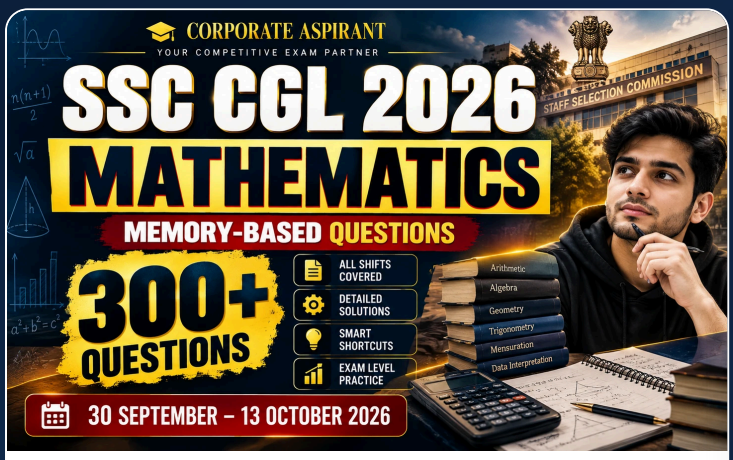
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Q12. **Select the correct conversion into direct speech.**

He remarked that, had the expedition team been better equipped, they might still have reached the summit before nightfall.

(A) He said, "If the expedition team was better equipped, they may still reach the summit before nightfall."

(B) He said, "Had the expedition team been better equipped, they must still have reached the summit before nightfall."

(C) He said, "Had the expedition team been better equipped, they might still have reached the summit before nightfall."

(D) He said, "If the expedition team had been better equipped, they will still reach the summit before nightfall."

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✓ **Correct Answer: (C)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The third conditional expresses an unreal past condition and its possible past consequence. The structure had + subject + past participle can replace if + subject + past perfect.

EXAMPLE

Example: He said that, had he known the truth, he might have acted differently.

EXAM TIP Do not replace might have with must have. They express different meanings: possibility and strong deduction, respectively.

Q13. **Consider the following sentences:**

Scarcely had the notification been issued than the establishments began to file their objections.

The Regional Commissioner, along with his two deputies, was present throughout the hearing.

He is one of those officers who never misses a deadline.

Identify which of the given three sentences are grammatically and contextually accurate.

(A) 1 and 2

(B) 2 only

(C) 2 and 3

(D) 1 and 3

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✓ **Correct Answer: (B) 2 only**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

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Sentence 1 is incorrect: The correct construction is Scarcely had ... when, not Scarcely had ... than.

Sentence 2 is correct: The main subject is singular (The Regional Commissioner). The phrase along with his two deputies does not change the subject's number, so was is correct.

Sentence 3 is incorrect: In "one of those officers who...", the relative pronoun who refers to the plural noun officers. Therefore, the verb should be miss, not misses.

Corrected sentences:

Scarcely had the notification been issued when the establishments began to file their objections.

He is one of those officers who never miss a deadline.

Q14. **Consider the following sentences:**

No sooner had the Tribunal risen than the parties resumed their negotiations in the corridor.

The quantum of arrears, together with the interest accruing thereon, are to be recovered within ninety days.

Neither of the two schemes has achieved the coverage that its framers had predicted.

Identify which of the given three sentences are grammatically and contextually accurate.

(A) 1 only

(B) 1 and 2

(C) 2 and 3

(D) 1 and 3

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✓ **Correct Answer: (D) 1 and 3**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Sentence 1 is correct: The standard construction is No sooner ... than.

Sentence 2 is incorrect: The main subject, The quantum, is singular. The phrase together with the interest does not make it plural. Therefore, are should be replaced with is.

Sentence 3 is correct: Neither takes a singular verb in this construction, so has achieved is appropriate.

Corrected sentence 2: The quantum of arrears, together with the interest accruing thereon, is to be recovered within ninety days.

Q15. **Choose the correctly spelt word to complete the sentence.**

"Her advice proved to be truly _____ to the success of the project."

(A) Indispensible

(B) Indespensable

(C) Indespensible

(D) Indispensable

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✦ EXPLANATION

Indispensable means absolutely necessary or essential.

Synonyms: Essential, necessary, vital, crucial, requisite.

Antonyms: Unnecessary, dispensable, optional, nonessential.

EXAMPLE

Example: Regular revision is indispensable for effective examination preparation.

Q16. **Select the most appropriate synonym of "ASPERITY".**

(A) Gentleness

(B) Harshness

(C) Patience

(D) Warmth

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Harshness**

✦ EXPLANATION

Asperity means harshness of tone, manner, or temper.

Synonyms: Harshness, severity, acrimony, bitterness, sharpness.

Antonyms: Gentleness, mildness, kindness, amiability.

EXAMPLE

Example: The manager responded with asperity when questioned about the delay.

Q17. **Rearrange the following sentences in the correct order to form a logical passage.**

The central bank then intervenes by adjusting interest rates to curb the resulting inflationary pressures.

Excess liquidity in the financial system consequently leads to a surge in consumer spending.

A chain of events is often triggered when governments resort to deficit financing beyond sustainable limits.

Rising demand, unchecked by supply constraints, ultimately translates into broad-based inflation.

(A) 3-2-4-1

(B) 2-3-4-1

(C) 3-4-2-1

(D) 2-4-3-1

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EXPLANATION

Sentence 3 introduces the process. Sentence 2 explains the resulting increase in spending, sentence 4 describes the resulting inflation, and sentence 1 concludes with the central bank's response.

Para Jumble Strategy:

Identify the introductory sentence.

Track connectors such as consequently, then, and ultimately.

Follow the cause-and-effect sequence.

Identify the concluding sentence.

Q18. **Select the most appropriate synonym of "AWRY".**

(A) Aligned

(B) Orderly

(C) Askew

(D) Symmetrical

Correct Answer: (C) Askew

EXPLANATION

Awry means away from the expected, correct, or planned course; it can also mean crooked or out of alignment.

Synonyms: Askew, amiss, crooked, faulty, wrong.

Antonyms: Correct, proper, orderly, aligned.

EXAMPLES:

The plan went awry. — The plan did not proceed as expected.

The picture hung askew. — The picture was not straight.

Q19. **Rearrange the following sentences to form a coherent paragraph.**

Human-driven climate change, caused by greenhouse gas emissions, is disrupting global ecosystems in many ways.

Polar ice melt and shrinking glaciers have accelerated, contributing to rising sea levels.

This has resulted in more frequent and severe extreme weather events such as droughts, floods, and heatwaves.

Together, these impacts pose a major threat to biodiversity and human societies.

(A) 2, 4, 3, 1

(B) 3, 1, 4, 2

(C) 1, 2, 3, 4

(D) 1, 4, 2, 3

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✓ **Correct Answer: (C) 1, 2, 3, 4**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Sentence 1 introduces climate change. Sentence 2 presents a specific impact, sentence 3 describes further consequences, and sentence 4 concludes with their combined effects.

EXAM TIP Words such as this, these, and together often indicate links with preceding sentences. Check their references before deciding the order.

Q20. **Rearrange the following sentences in the correct order to form a logical passage.**

This, in turn, strengthens the capacity to assess evidence and resist manipulation.

Critical thinking is among the most valued competencies in the modern knowledge economy.

It encompasses skills such as logical reasoning, structured argumentation, and reflective analysis.

Systematic instruction in critical thinking should therefore be embedded across educational curricula.

(A) 2-1-3-4

(B) 2-3-1-4

(C) 3-2-4-1

(D) 2-4-1-3

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✓ **Correct Answer: (B) 2-3-1-4**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Sentence 2 introduces critical thinking. Sentence 3 explains its components, sentence 1 describes its benefit, and sentence 4 concludes with a recommendation.

Para Jumble Tip: Pronouns such as it and this usually refer to ideas introduced earlier. Words such as therefore often signal a conclusion or recommendation.

Q21. **Rearrange the following sentences to form a coherent paragraph.**

As a result, urban planners are now focusing on climate-resilient infrastructure.

Extreme weather events have become more frequent in recent years.

These developments have exposed vulnerabilities in existing city systems.

Flooded roads, heatwaves, and power outages are increasingly common.

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(A) 2, 4, 3, 1

(B) 4, 2, 1, 3

(C) 1, 3, 2, 4

(D) 3, 2, 4, 1

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) 2, 4, 3, 1**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Sentence 2 introduces the issue. Sentence 4 provides examples, sentence 3 explains their significance, and sentence 1 gives the resulting response by urban planners.

Sequence: General statement → Examples → Consequences → Response.

Q22. **Choose the option that most accurately conveys the sentence in direct speech.**

She wondered whether she could ever reconcile her ambitions with her commitments.

(A) She said, "Could I ever reconcile my ambitions with my commitments?"

(B) She wondered, "Can I ever reconcile my ambitions with my commitments?"

(C) She asked, "Will I ever reconcile my ambitions with my commitments?"

(D) She wondered, "Shall I reconcile my ambitions with my commitments?"

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) She wondered, "Can I ever reconcile my ambitions with my commitments?"**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The indirect question expresses uncertainty about whether she can balance her ambitions and commitments. The direct form restores the first-person perspective and the original question structure.

EXAM RULE Indirect yes/no questions generally use whether or if and statement word order. Direct questions use interrogative word order.

EXAMPLE

Example: He asked whether I was ready. → He asked, "Are you ready?"

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Q23. **Select the most appropriate antonym of "RECALCITRANCE".**

(A) Obstinacy

(B) Compliance

(C) Insubordination

(D) Contumacy

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Compliance**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Recalcitrance means stubborn resistance to authority, rules, or control. Compliance means acting in accordance with rules or instructions.

Synonyms of recalcitrance: Obstinacy, defiance, insubordination, disobedience, contumacy.

Antonyms: Compliance, obedience, submission, acquiescence.

EXAMPLE

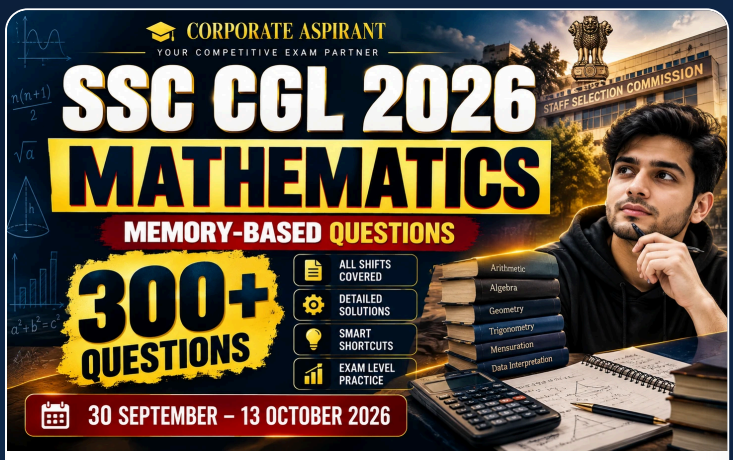
Example: The officer's compliance with the regulations ensured that the procedure was completed correctly.

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Q24. **Select the most appropriate antonym of "OPULENT".**

(A) Wealthy

(B) Luxurious

(C) Impoverished

(D) Ostentatious

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Impoverished**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Opulent means extremely wealthy or luxurious. Impoverished means poor or deprived of financial resources.

Synonyms of opulent: Affluent, wealthy, prosperous, luxurious, lavish.

Antonyms: Impoverished, destitute, indigent, poor.

EXAMPLE

Example: The opulent palace contrasted sharply with the impoverished settlement nearby.

Q25. **Fill in the blank with the correct expression.**

Far from the applause she expected, her speech _____.

(A) Fell out

(B) Fell off

(C) Fell flat

(D) Fell foul

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Fell flat**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Fall flat means to fail to produce the intended effect or to receive little or no favourable response.

Related Expressions:

Fall out: Quarrel or have a disagreement.

Fall off: Decrease or decline.

Fall foul of: Come into conflict with a rule, authority, or person.

Fall through: Fail to happen as planned.

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EXAMPLE

Example: His attempt at humour fell flat because nobody laughed.

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Cloze Test

Directions (1–5): Read the passage and answer the following questions.

Swimming is one of the most popular recreational and competitive activities worldwide, valued for both its fitness benefits and its ability to provide relaxation. Unlike many forms of exercise, swimming is (1) low-impact, making it ideal for people of all ages and fitness levels. The buoyancy of water supports the body, reducing strain on joints while still _____(3) resistance to build muscle strength and endurance.

Beyond its physical advantages, swimming is also a valuable life skill. Knowing how to swim can be (2) "life-saving" in emergencies and helps individuals enjoy other water-based activities such as boating, diving, and surfing. Competitive swimming, on the other hand, demands rigorous training, discipline, and excellent technique.

Different strokes—freestyle, backstroke, breaststroke, and butterfly—engage various muscle groups and require distinct breathing patterns. Regular swimming improves cardiovascular health, increases lung capacity, and promotes overall well-being. It is also an effective way to reduce stress, as the rhythmic movements and sensation of being in water can have a calming effect on the mind.

However, safety is crucial. Swimmers should always be aware of _____(4) environment, whether in pools, lakes, or the ocean, and follow proper safety guidelines. Learning under supervision _____(5) using appropriate gear ensures a safe and enjoyable experience.

Q1. **In the passage, what does "low-impact" most nearly mean?**

(A) Requiring too much effort

(B) Causing minimal stress or strain on the body

(C) Ineffective

(D) Slow and boring

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Causing minimal stress or strain on the body**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Low-impact describes an activity that places relatively little stress on the joints and body. Swimming is considered low-impact because water supports body weight and reduces joint loading.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Strenuous — Requiring considerable physical effort.

Intense — Involving a high degree of effort or activity.

Gentle — Having little force or impact.

Rigorous — Thorough, demanding, or strict.

Q2. The phrase “life-saving” most nearly means:

(A) Something that saves or protects a person's life

(B) Something that helps earn money

(C) Something that is very enjoyable

(D) Something that improves appearance

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) Something that saves or protects a person's life**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Life-saving refers to something that prevents death or helps protect someone from a life-threatening situation.

Related Expressions:

Life-threatening — Potentially causing death.

Life-preserving — Helping to maintain life.

Vital — Absolutely necessary.

Crucial — Extremely important.

Q3. Choose the correct form of the verb for blank (3).

The buoyancy of water supports the body, reducing strain on joints while still _____ resistance to build muscle strength and endurance.

(A) Provide

(B) Provides

(C) Providing

(D) Provided

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Providing**

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✦ EXPLANATION

The word while is followed here by the participial phrase providing resistance. The structure describes an action occurring simultaneously with the reduction of strain.

GRAMMAR RULE A participial phrase can describe an action occurring alongside the main action.

EXAMPLE

Example: She walked down the road while talking on the phone.

Q4. Choose the correct pronoun for blank (4).

Swimmers should always be aware of _____ environment, whether in pools, lakes, or the ocean.

(A) Our

(B) Their

(C) Yours

(D) His

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Their**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Their refers to the plural subject swimmers. It is a possessive determiner showing that the environment belongs to or surrounds the swimmers.

GRAMMAR RULE A pronoun or possessive determiner must agree appropriately with its antecedent.

EXAMPLES:

Students should bring their identity cards.

The swimmer should check his or her equipment.

Q5. Choose the correct conjunction for blank (5).

Learning under supervision _____ using appropriate gear ensures a safe and enjoyable experience.

(A) Or

(B) But

(C) And

(D) While

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Correct Answer: (C) And

EXPLANATION

The conjunction and connects two complementary safety measures: learning under supervision and using appropriate gear.

Important Conjunctions:

And — Adds information.

But — Expresses contrast.

Or — Presents alternatives.

While — Indicates simultaneous actions or contrast.

Q6. **Rearrange the following sentence parts to form a meaningful and grammatically correct paragraph.**

P. He presented his diagnosis and suggested a course of treatment with assurance.

Q. In order to search for particular markers, he ordered a number of imaging scans and blood tests.

R. He went over all the information, comparing it to what he knew about medicine.

S. As the patient explained their symptoms, the doctor paid close attention.

(A) S, P, R, Q

(B) Q, S, R, P

(C) S, Q, R, P

(D) P, Q, R, S

Correct Answer: (C) S, Q, R, P

EXPLANATION

Sentence S introduces the consultation. Sentence Q describes the tests ordered, sentence R explains the evaluation of information, and sentence P concludes with the diagnosis and treatment recommendation.

EXAM TIP In sentence rearrangement, identify the introductory sentence first, then follow the logical sequence of actions and conclusions.

Q7. **Select the option that can replace the given group of words.**

A family name derived from the name of a father or ancestor, typically a surname.

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(A) Matronymic

(B) Patronymic

(C) Ancestry

(D) Heritage

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✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Patronymic**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

A patronymic is a name derived from the name of one's father or a male ancestor.

Related Terms:

Matronymic — A name derived from the name of one's mother.

Ancestry — A person's family origins or lineage.

Heritage — Traditions, culture, or characteristics inherited from previous generations.

Genealogy — The study of family history and descent.

Q8. **Choose the most appropriate conversion into Direct Speech.**

The interviewer asked me why I had left my previous job.

(A) The interviewer said, “Why did you leave your previous job?”

(B) The interviewer said, “Why you have left your previous job?”

(C) The interviewer said, “Why you had left your previous job?”

(D) The interviewer asked me, “Why you left your previous job?”

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✓ **Correct Answer: (A) The interviewer said, “Why did you leave your previous job?”**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The indirect question is restored to direct-question form. The past perfect had left corresponds to the simple past did leave in the direct question.

GRAMMAR RULE Direct questions require interrogative word order.

EXAMPLE

Example: She asked me where I lived. → She asked me, “Where do you live?”

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Q9. Identify the part containing the error.

To court a broader audience, the campaign highlighted the most unique features of the device, claiming that no comparable product has ever achieved such singular efficiency in independent tests across continental markets.

(A) No error

(B) To court a broader audience, the campaign highlighted the most unique features of the device,

(C) claiming that no comparable product has ever achieved such singular efficiency

(D) in independent tests across continental markets.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (B)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

In traditional competitive-exam grammar, unique means one of a kind and is treated as an absolute adjective. Therefore, the expected correction is the unique features rather than the most unique features.

Corrected sentence: To court a broader audience, the campaign highlighted the unique features of the device, claiming that no comparable product has ever achieved such singular efficiency in independent tests across continental markets.

EXAM TIP Traditional exam questions often test absolute adjectives such as unique, perfect, universal, and impossible. However, in actual English usage, modifiers such as more unique sometimes occur when uniqueness is treated as a matter of degree.

Q10. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom “Read somebody the Riot Act”.

(A) To explain a rule in great detail

(B) To participate in a public protest

(C) To read aloud from a law textbook

(D) To reprimand someone very severely

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) To reprimand someone very severely**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Read someone the Riot Act means to give someone a strong warning or reprimand about unacceptable behaviour.

Related Idioms:

Pull someone up — Reprimand someone.

Give someone a dressing-down — Criticise someone severely.

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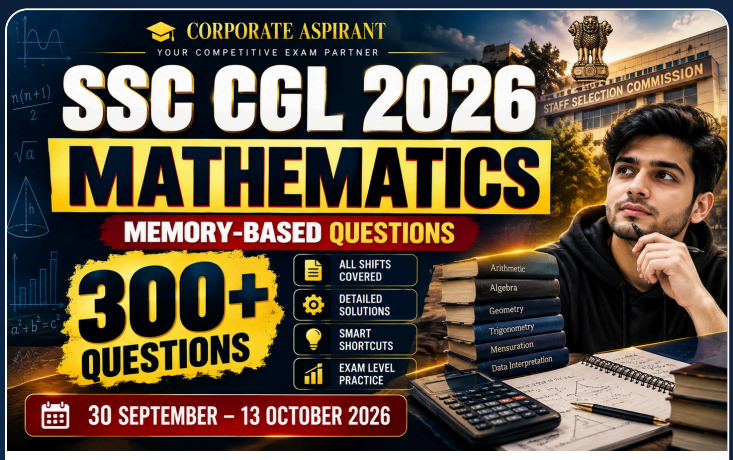
Come down hard on someone — Treat someone strictly or punish them severely.

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Q11. **Select the sentence containing the homonym of the highlighted word “file”.**

He used a hand file to smooth the metal's rough edges.

(A) He used the new file to smooth the wood.

(B) The technician used a special file to shape the plastic.

(C) He had to file his nails before applying the nail paint.

(D) She put all the important papers in a single file.

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) She put all the important papers in a single file.**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

In the original sentence, file refers to a tool used for smoothing a surface. In option D, file refers to a collection or orderly arrangement of documents.

MORE EXAMPLES:

Bat — A flying mammal; a piece of sports equipment.

Bark — The outer covering of a tree; the sound made by a dog.

Match — A contest; a small stick used to produce fire.

Bank — A financial institution; the land beside a river.

Q12. **Choose the most appropriate conversion into Direct Speech.**

He said that he had been waiting for that opportunity for years.

(A) He said, “I have been waiting for the opportunity for years.”

(B) He said, “I am waiting for that opportunity for years.”

(C) He said, “I have been waiting for this opportunity for years.”

(D) He said, “I waited for that opportunity for years.”

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) He said, “I have been waiting for this opportunity for years.”**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The indirect form uses the past perfect continuous (had been waiting), which corresponds to the present perfect continuous (have been waiting) in the restored direct speech. The demonstrative that changes back to this when the opportunity is referred to from the speaker's original perspective.

GRAMMAR RULE Under normal backshift, present perfect continuous changes to past perfect continuous in reported speech.

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EXAMPLE

Example: He said, “I have been studying.” → He said that he had been studying.

Q13. **Which word is nearest in meaning to “demonstrating” in the sentence below?**

“This trend is already booming in China, demonstrating significant potential globally.”

(A) Exhibiting

(B) Displaying

(C) Showcasing

(D) Revealing

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Showcasing**

✦ EXPLANATION

In this context, demonstrating means showing or displaying a quality or potential. Showcasing is the intended option.

Synonyms: Showing, exhibiting, displaying, illustrating, revealing, highlighting.

EXAMPLE

Example: The project is showcasing the potential of renewable energy.

Q14. **Identify the part containing the error.**

When I see the spot (A)/ I am reminded of an unique incident (B)/ that took place (C)/ several years ago. (D)

(A) A

(B) B

(C) C

(D) D

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) B**

✦ EXPLANATION

The article an is incorrect before unique because the word begins with the consonant sound /j/, as in “you”.

Correct sentence: When I see the spot, I am reminded of a unique incident that took place several years ago.

GRAMMAR RULE

Use a or an according to the initial sound, not simply the initial letter.

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EXAMPLES:

A university — Begins with a /j/ sound.

An hour — Begins with a vowel sound because h is silent.

A European country — Begins with a /j/ sound.

An honest person — Begins with a vowel sound.

Q15. Choose the most appropriate conversion into Direct Speech.

The teacher reminded the students to submit their assignments by Friday.

(A) The teacher said to the students, "Your assignments must be submitted by Friday."

(B) The teacher reminded, "You have to submit your assignments by Friday."

(C) The teacher reminded the students, "Submit your assignments by Friday."

(D) The teacher said to the students, "You should submitted your assignments by Friday."

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) The teacher reminded the students, "Submit your assignments by Friday."**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

The indirect form to submit represents an instruction. In direct speech, the imperative verb submit restores the original command.

GRAMMAR RULE An affirmative imperative generally changes to to + verb in indirect speech.

EXAMPLE

Example: The teacher said to me, "Complete your work." → The teacher instructed me to complete my work.

Q16. Choose the most suitable preposition to fill in the blank.

The footfall has gone up ___ ten percent.

(A) With

(B) For

(C) By

(D) Of

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) By**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

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EXAMPLES:

Sales increased by 15%.

Prices fell by ₹50.

Attendance rose by 10%.

Important Distinction:

Increase by 10% — The amount of increase.

Increase to 10% — The final level reaches 10%.

Q17. What does the idiom "the best of both worlds" typically mean?

(A) The worst situation possible

(B) Having advantages of two different things

(C) Being stuck between two choices

(D) Choosing the better option

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Having advantages of two different things**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The idiom refers to a situation in which someone enjoys the benefits of two different opportunities or circumstances simultaneously.

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EXAMPLE

Example: Working remotely while earning a city-level salary gives her the best of both worlds.

Related Idioms:

Have it both ways — Enjoy two alternatives, sometimes inconsistently.

Win-win situation — An outcome beneficial to all parties.

Cake and eat it too — Want to enjoy two incompatible advantages.

Q18. Which word can best replace "ingenuity" in the sentence below?

"The ancient Egyptians demonstrated remarkable ingenuity in their architectural designs."

(A) Creativity

(B) Stupidity

(C) Simplicity

(D) Ignorance

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EXPLANATION

Ingenuity means the ability to think creatively and develop clever or original solutions.

Synonyms: Creativity, inventiveness, resourcefulness, originality, innovation.

Antonyms: Stupidity, unimaginativeness, ineptitude.

EXAMPLE

Example: The engineer's ingenuity helped solve a complex technical problem.

Q19. Arrange the jumbled sentences in a logical sequence. S1 and S2 are fixed.

S1: An old man came up to me in the fog.

A. The people here call him insane.

B. I know him well.

C. He lives alone in a little house buried deep in the forest and has a small dog he carries always in his arms.

D. "He is a little cracked," they say.

S2: On many mornings I have met him walking on the road and he has told me of men and women who were his brothers and sisters, his cousins, aunts, uncles, brothers-in-law.

(A) BADC

(B) ADBC

(C) DCBA

(D) BCAD

Correct Answer: (A) BADC

EXPLANATION

Sentence B establishes the narrator's familiarity with the old man. Sentence A introduces what the local people think of him. Sentence D gives their direct description, and sentence C adds details about his life.

Sequence: B → A → D → C.

EXAM TIP In para jumbles, identify pronoun references, quotation links, and the relationship between general statements and supporting details.

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Q20. Change the following sentence into active voice.

The decision will have been announced before the meeting concludes.

(A) Someone was announced the decision before the meeting concludes.

(B) They will have announced the decision before the meeting concludes.

(C) The decision will be announced before the meeting concludes.

(D) The meeting will have announced the decision.

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) They will have announced the decision before the meeting concludes.**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The passive construction will have been announced changes to the active construction will have announced. The object the decision becomes the object of the active verb.

GRAMMAR RULE

Active: Subject + will have + past participle + object.

Passive: Object + will have been + past participle.

EXAMPLE

Example: The results will have been declared by Monday. → The authorities will have declared the results by Monday.

Q21. Fill in the blank with the correctly spelt word.

The scientist was known for her _____ adherence to ethical standards.

(A) Unasssailable

(B) Unassailable

(C) Unasailable

(D) Unassailible

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Unassailable**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Unassailable means impossible to challenge, attack, or disprove successfully.

Synonyms: Indisputable, irrefutable, incontrovertible, unquestionable.

Antonyms: Vulnerable, questionable, disputable.

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Q22. **Select the correctly spelt word.**

(A) Bourgeosie

(B) Bourgoisie

(C) Bourgeoisie

(D) Boorgeoisie

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Bourgeoisie**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Bourgeoisie refers to the middle class, especially in social, economic, and political contexts.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Proletariat — The working class, particularly in Marxist terminology.

Aristocracy — The highest social class, traditionally associated with hereditary privilege.

Elite — A group considered superior in status, ability, or influence.

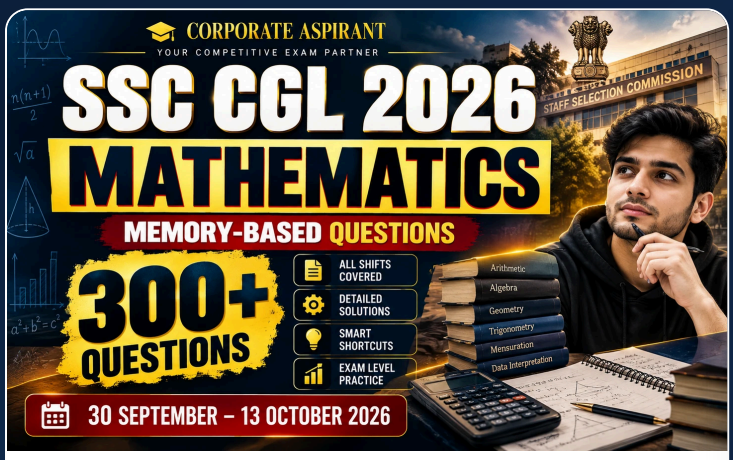
Spelling Tip: Remember the sequence bour-geoi-sie in bourgeoisie.

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Q23. **Select the most appropriate synonym of "Adamant".**

(A) Lax

(B) Flexible

(C) Stubborn

(D) Genuine

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Stubborn**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Adamant means refusing to change one's opinion or decision; firmly determined.

Synonyms: Stubborn, resolute, inflexible, unyielding, obstinate.

Antonyms: Flexible, yielding, compliant, accommodating.

EXAMPLE

Example: She was adamant that the rules should be followed.

Q24. **Select the wrongly spelt word.**

(A) Exasperete

(B) Separate

(C) Equivalent

(D) Temperature

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) Exasperete**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

The correct spelling is exasperate, meaning to irritate or frustrate someone intensely.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Exasperated — Extremely annoyed.

Irritate — To annoy or provoke.

Aggravate — To make a problem or situation worse; also to annoy.

Infuriate — To make someone extremely angry.

Spelling Tip: The correct spelling is exasperate, not exasperete.

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Q25. **Choose the most appropriate conversion into active voice.**

A table was reserved for the family at the restaurant.

(A) They reserved a table for the family at the restaurant.

(B) The family reserved a table for them at the restaurant.

(C) The restaurant reserved a table for the family by them.

(D) They were reserving a table for the family at the restaurant.

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) They reserved a table for the family at the restaurant.**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

The passive sentence is in the simple past tense. In the active form, the implied agent becomes the subject, and was reserved changes to reserved.

GRAMMAR RULE

Active: Subject + past-tense verb + object.

Passive: Object + was/were + past participle.

EXAMPLE

Example: The room was cleaned by the staff. → The staff cleaned the room.

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Q1. **Which of the following pairs of words can be used to fill in the blanks most suitably?**

The ____ sorcerer upturned the ____ of poison into the goblet, his lips curling into a smirk.

(A) Veil, vail

(B) Vail, veil

(C) Vial, vile

(D) Vile, vial

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) Vile, vial**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Vile means extremely unpleasant or morally wicked, while a vial is a small container used for liquids or medicines.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Veil: A piece of cloth used to cover the face or head.

Vail: An archaic word meaning to lower or take off, especially a hat, as a sign of respect.

Vial: A small container for liquids.

Vile: Extremely unpleasant or morally reprehensible.

EXAMPLE

Example: The vile substance was stored in a sealed vial.

Q2. Select the word opposite in meaning to "Ensconce".

(A) Establish

(B) Impudence

(C) Request

(D) Unveil

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) Unveil**

✦ EXPLANATION

Ensconce means to settle or establish someone or something securely in a comfortable or protected position. Unveil means to uncover or reveal something.

Synonyms of Ensconce: Settle, establish, install, lodge.

Related Antonyms: Dislodge, uncover, expose, reveal.

EXAMPLE

Example: The artist unveiled her latest painting at the exhibition.

Q3. Examine the given sentence and identify the part containing an error.

In order to overcome the mental depression and stress (1) adapting meditation, yoga or (2) similar other methods (3) can be helped (4).

(A) Adapting meditation, yoga or

(B) Can be helped

(C) In order to overcome the mental depression and stress

(D) Similar other methods

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Correct Answer: (B) Can be helped

EXPLANATION

The phrase can be helped is grammatically incorrect in this context. The sentence needs a construction such as can be overcome or can be managed.

Corrected sentence: In order to overcome mental depression and stress, methods such as meditation and yoga can be adopted.

EXAM RULE

Modal verbs such as can, could, should, and must are followed by the base form of the verb in active constructions.

EXAMPLE

Example: We can solve the problem.

Q4. Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Subcompartmentalization

(B) Subcompartmenetalization

(C) Subcomaprtmentalization

(D) Subcompartmentaliztion

Correct Answer: (A) Subcompartmentalization

EXPLANATION

Subcompartmentalization refers to the division of something into smaller compartments or subdivisions.

Spelling Tip: Break the word into parts: sub + compartment + alization.

Additional Exam-Relevant Words:

Compartmentalize — Divide into separate sections.

Categorization — Classification into groups.

Decentralization — Distribution of authority away from a central authority.

Institutionalization — Establishment of something as a formal practice.

Q5. Choose the most appropriate conversion into Direct Speech.

The professor admitted that he had never delivered a lecture on that particular topic in any of his classes.

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(A) The professor said, "I've never delivered a lecture on this particular topic in any of my classes."

(B) The professor admitted, "I'd never delivered a lecture on that particular topic in any class."

(C) The professor admitted, "I have not deliver a lecture on that particular topic in any of my classes."

(D) The professor said, "I have never delivered a lecture on this particular topic in none of my classes."

✓ **Correct Answer: (A)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

In direct speech, he changes to I, his changes to my, and that particular topic becomes this particular topic when the speaker refers to the topic from their original perspective.

GRAMMAR RULE Reported past perfect constructions can revert to present perfect when reconstructing the original direct speech.

EXAMPLE

Example: He said that he had completed the task. → He said, "I have completed the task."

Q6. **Select the correct direct narration of the given indirect narration.**

Sanvi told Prakash that the coach had announced that practice would be cancelled for the rest of the week due to the flooded condition of the playing fields.

(A) Sanvi said to Prakash, "The coach is announcing that practice would be cancelled for the rest of the week due to the flooded condition of the playing fields."

(B) Sanvi said to Prakash, "The coach announced that practice would have been cancelled for the rest of the week due to the flooded condition of the playing fields."

(C) Sanvi said to Prakash, "The coach announced that practice would be cancelled for the rest of the week due to the flooded condition of the playing fields."

(D) Sanvi said to Prakash, "The coach announced that practice would be cancelling for the rest of the week due to the flooded condition of the playing fields."

✓ **Correct Answer: (C)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The reported clause had announced is restored to announced. The future-in-the-past construction would be cancelled remains appropriate because the cancellation was still in the future relative to the coach's announcement.

EXAM TIP Do not change would to would have unless the sentence requires a conditional or a past hypothetical meaning.

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Q7. **Find the word most nearly similar in meaning to “Prolific”.**

(A) Fruitful

(B) Barren

(C) Furtive

(D) Amiable

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) Fruitful**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Prolific means producing a large amount of something, especially work, results, or offspring.

Synonyms: Productive, fruitful, fertile, creative, abundant.

Antonyms: Barren, unproductive, infertile, fruitless.

EXAMPLE

Example: The prolific writer published several books in a single year.

Vocabulary Distinction:

Furtive: Secretive or attempting to avoid notice.

Amiable: Friendly and pleasant.

Barren: Unable to produce; unproductive.

Q8. **Choose the correct one-word substitute for “A speech or piece of writing that praises someone highly.”**

(A) Elegy

(B) Encomium

(C) Sermon

(D) Soliloquy

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Encomium**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

An encomium is a formal expression of high praise for a person, achievement, or thing.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Elegy: A poem or piece of writing expressing sorrow, especially for the dead.

Sermon: A religious or moral discourse.

Soliloquy: A speech delivered by a character alone, expressing their thoughts

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Panegyric: A formal public speech or piece of writing praising someone or something.

EXAM TIP Encomium, eulogy, and panegyric are especially useful words for one-word substitution questions.

Q9. **Find the word most nearly similar in meaning to "Obstreperous".**

(A) Unruly

(B) Docile

(C) Prudent

(D) Ambivalent

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) Unruly**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Obstreperous describes someone who is noisy, difficult to control, or aggressively disruptive.

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Synonyms: Unruly, disorderly, boisterous, rowdy, clamorous.

Antonyms: Docile, obedient, compliant, subdued.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Prudent: Wise and careful in making decisions.

Ambivalent: Having mixed or conflicting feelings.

Docile: Easily managed or controlled.

EXAMPLE

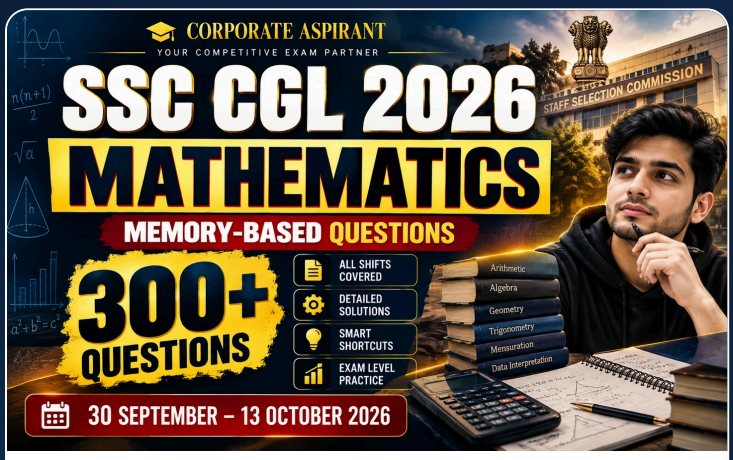
Example: The teacher struggled to control the obstreperous students.

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Q10. **Arrange the following sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**

A. This shift is driven by the fact that electric vehicles produce lower emissions compared to conventional cars.

B. Moreover, advances in battery technology have improved driving range and reduced costs.

C. Therefore, governments are incentivizing EV adoption through subsidies and tax benefits.

D. Electric vehicles (EVs) are becoming a major component of sustainable transportation worldwide.

(A) B – A – C – D

(B) C – A – B – D

(C) C – B – A – D

(D) D – A – B – C

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✓ **Correct Answer: (D) D – A – B – C**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Sentence D introduces the topic. Sentence A explains the environmental reason behind the shift, sentence B adds another supporting factor, and sentence C concludes with the resulting government response.

Sequence: Introduction → Environmental benefit → Technological improvement → Government action.

EXAM TIP Words such as moreover add supporting information, while therefore usually introduces a conclusion or consequence.

Cloze Test

Directions (11–15): Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The digital revolution, for all its emancipatory promise, has spawned a (1) _____ of misinformation that threatens the very foundations of informed discourse. Algorithms engineered to maximise engagement tend to privilege sensational content over sober analysis, thereby creating echo chambers in which pre-existing prejudices are relentlessly reinforced. Falsehoods, often cloaked in a veneer of authority, propagate with a speed that verified facts can seldom match.

What makes this phenomenon particularly (2) _____ is its subtlety. Unlike overt propaganda, which audiences can readily identify and resist, modern disinformation masquerades as ordinary opinion, insinuating itself into conversations with deceptive ease. Even discerning readers occasionally find themselves unwittingly sharing claims that later prove to be entirely (3) _____.

Regulators face a formidable dilemma. Heavy-handed censorship risks (4) _____ the freedom of expression that democratic

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companies, for their part, have been accused of equivocating, professing a commitment to truth while profiting handsomely from the very outrage they claim to deplore.

A durable solution, experts contend, must be multifaceted. Media literacy should be embedded in school curricula, enabling young citizens to scrutinise sources and detect manipulation. Simultaneously, platforms must be held accountable for the opaque architecture of their algorithms. Ultimately, however, the (5) _____ of truth rests with each individual, for no regulatory framework can wholly substitute for a sceptical and inquisitive mind.

Q11. **Select the correct option for blank (1).**

(A) Dearth

(B) Paucity

(C) Deluge

(D) Modicum

✓ **Correct Answer: (C) Deluge**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Deluge means a large or overwhelming quantity. A deluge of misinformation means an overwhelming flood of false or misleading information.

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RELATED VOCABULARY:

Dearth: A scarcity or shortage.

Paucity: An insufficiency or small quantity.

Modicum: A small amount.

Surfeit: An excessive quantity.

Plethora: A very large or excessive amount.

EXAMPLE

Example: Social media platforms face a deluge of unverified claims during major events.

Q12. **Select the correct option for blank (2).**

(A) Insidious

(B) Benign

(C) Innocuous

(D) Salubrious

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) Insidious**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Insidious describes something harmful that operates subtly or gradually, often without being noticed. The passage emphasises the deceptive and subtle nature of misinformation.

Synonyms: Sly, stealthy, pernicious, treacherous, subtle.

Antonyms: Benign, harmless, innocuous, beneficial.

Related Words:

Salubrious: Health-promoting or beneficial.

Benign: Harmless or gentle.

Innocuous: Not harmful or offensive.

Q13. **Select the correct option for blank (3).**

(A) Authentic

(B) Veracious

(C) Cogent

(D) Spurious

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) Spurious**

✦ EXPLANATION

Spurious means false, misleading, or not genuine. It fits the passage because the claims later turn out to be false.

Synonyms: False, counterfeit, fraudulent, bogus, fallacious.

Antonyms: Authentic, genuine, valid, veracious.

EXAMPLE

Example: The investigation exposed several spurious claims circulating online.

Q14. **Select the correct option for blank (4).**

(A) Bolstering

(B) Curtailing

(C) Fortifying

(D) Espousing

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) Curtailing**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Curtailing means reducing, restricting, or limiting something. The sentence warns that excessive censorship could restrict freedom of expression.

Synonyms: Restricting, limiting, diminishing, reducing.

Antonyms: Expanding, promoting, extending, enhancing.

EXAMPLE

Example: Excessive restrictions risk curtailing legitimate public debate.

Q15. **Select the correct option for blank (5).**

(A) Custodianship

(B) Abdication

(C) Repudiation

(D) Renunciation

✓ **Correct Answer: (A) Custodianship**

✦ EXPLANATION

Custodianship means the responsibility of protecting, preserving, or taking care of something. The sentence suggests that individuals have a responsibility to safeguard truth.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Abdication: Giving up a position or responsibility.

Repudiation: Rejection or refusal to accept something.

Renunciation: Formal abandonment of a claim, right, or belief.

Stewardship: Responsible management or protection of something.

EXAMPLE

Example: Responsible journalism involves the custodianship of accurate information.

Q16. **Choose the most suitable set of prepositions to complete the sentence.**

The children are playing _____ the garden _____ their friends.

(A) In, with

(B) On, among

(C) At, with

(D) Into, for

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Correct Answer: (A) In, with

EXPLANATION

In the garden identifies the location, while with their friends identifies the people accompanying the children.

GRAMMAR RULE

In the garden — Inside an area.

With friends — In someone's company.

At the park — At a particular place.

Among friends — In the company of a group.

EXAMPLE

Example: The children were playing in the park with their classmates.

Q17. **Select the correct passive voice of the following sentence.**

Take a pair of binoculars with you lest you all should miss the chance of looking at the distant scenes.

(A) Let a pair of binoculars be taken with you lest the chance of looking at the distant scenes would missed by you all.

(B) Let a pair of binoculars taken with you lest the chance of looking at the distant scenes should be missed by you all.

(C) Let a pair of binoculars be taken with you otherwise the chance of looking at the distant scenes would be missed by you all.

(D) Let a pair of binoculars be taken with you lest the chance of looking at the distant scenes should be missed by you all.

Correct Answer: (D)

EXPLANATION

The passive form of the affirmative imperative begins with Let + object + be + past participle. The clause introduced by lest expresses a precaution against an undesirable outcome.

Rule: Active imperative → Let + object + be + past participle.

EXAMPLE

Example: Keep the documents safely. → Let the documents be kept safely.

EXAM NOTE

Option D is the intended answer among the supplied options. Its wording is formal and somewhat awkward; the natural construction would be "Take a pair of binoculars with you lest you should miss the opportunity to see the distant scenery."

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Q18. Choose the best option to fill in the blanks.

This is ____ biryani I have had in a year. It is almost ____ the one from Nizam's House in Hyderabad.

(A) A, gooder than

(B) The better, as good as

(C) A, better

(D) The best, as good as

✓ **Correct Answer: (D) The best, as good as**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The best is the superlative form of good and is used when comparing one item with all others in a group or period. As good as expresses equality in quality.

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Grammar Rules:

Good → Better → Best.

As + adjective + as expresses equality.

The + superlative adjective is used to identify the highest degree.

EXAMPLES:

This is the best book I have read this year.

Her performance was as good as his.

Q19. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom "Open the floodgates".

(A) To close all opportunities

(B) To release something that was previously under control

(C) To stop people from entering

(D) To control emotions

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) To release something that was previously under control**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Open the floodgates means to allow something to happen or spread on a large scale after a restriction has been removed.

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Related Idioms:

Let the cat out of the bag: Reveal a secret.

Break the dam: Release something that has been held back.

Set the ball rolling: Initiate an activity.

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EXAMPLE

Example: The new policy opened the floodgates to private investment.

Q20. **Choose the correct meaning of the idiom "To square the circle".**

(A) To solve an easy problem

(B) To attempt something impossible

(C) To complete work quickly

(D) To draw a perfect figure

✓ **Correct Answer: (B) To attempt something impossible**

✦ EXPLANATION

To square the circle means to attempt an impossible or extremely difficult task, especially one involving contradictory requirements.

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Related Expressions:

Mission impossible: A task that appears impossible to accomplish.

Between the devil and the deep blue sea: Facing two equally difficult alternatives.

A Herculean task: An extremely difficult undertaking.

Move heaven and earth: Make every possible effort.

EXAMPLE

Example: Balancing unlimited spending with zero borrowing may be an attempt to square the circle.

Q21. **Change the following sentence into active form.**

The construction of the skyscraper is scheduled to have been completed by the end of the year.

(A) The skyscraper will have completed the construction by the end of the year.

(B) They are scheduling to have completed the construction of the skyscraper by the end of the year.

(C) The construction of the skyscraper will be completed by the end of the year.

(D) They are scheduled to complete the construction of the skyscraper by the end of the year.

✓ **Correct Answer: (D)**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

The passive construction refers to a planned completion. Option D introduces an agent, they, and expresses the planned action in active form.

Natural active sentence: They are scheduled to complete the construction of the skyscraper by the end of the year.

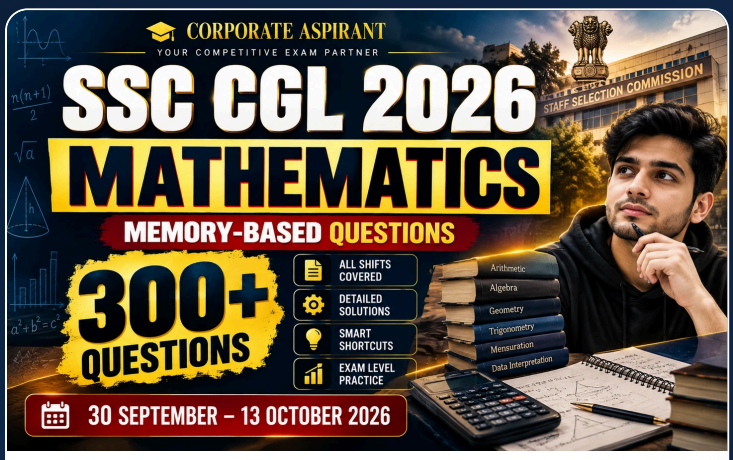
EXAM TIP When converting voice, preserve the intended meaning and time reference. Do not change the object into an agent without a grammatical reason.

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Q22. Identify the incorrectly spelt word in the sentence and rectify it.

During the preliminary reconnnaissance of the floodplain, the geologists catalogued subterranean fissures and recommended immediate remediation.

(A) Reconnaissance

(B) Recomended

(C) Remidiation

(D) Prelimenary

Source Answer: (A) Reconnaissance

EXPLANATION

The sentence contains the spelling reconnnaissance, with an extra n. The correct spelling is reconnaissance, meaning a preliminary survey or inspection conducted to gather information.

Important correction: Option A supplies the correct spelling, reconnaissance, rather than the misspelt form appearing in the sentence. Therefore, the question's wording and options are inconsistent. The intended correction is:

Incorrect: Reconnnaissance

Correct: Reconnaissance

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Preliminary — Occurring before the main event.

Survey — A systematic examination.

Inspection — Careful examination.

Remediation — The process of correcting or remedying a problem.

Q23. Identify the part of the sentence containing an error.

The child requested his mother to gave him a big chocolate because he had been very good all day long and deserved a treat.

(A) The child requested his mother to

(B) Gave him a big chocolate because he

(C) Had been very good all day

(D) Long and deserved a treat.

✓ **Correct Answer: (B)**

EXPLANATION

The infinitive marker to must be followed by the base form of the verb. Therefore, to gave is incorrect; it should be to give.

Corrected sentence: The child requested his mother to give him a big chocolate because he had been very good all day long and deserved a treat.

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GRAMMAR RULE To + base form of the verb.

EXAMPLES:

To go, not to went.

To write, not to wrote.

To speak, not to spoke.

Q24. Select the correct indirect narration of the given direct narration.

Pari said to Nirvaan, "He admitted that he had made a huge mistake in judgment when he decided to invest all his money in that risky startup company."

(A) Pari told Nirvaan that he had admitted that he had made a huge mistake in judgment when he decided to invest all his money in that risky startup company.

(B) Pari told Nirvaan that he had made a huge mistake in judgment when he decided to invest all his money in that risky startup company.

(C) Pari told Nirvaan that he had admitted that he made a huge mistake in judgment when he decided to invest all his money in that risky startup company.

(D) Pari told Nirvaan that he had admitted that he had made a huge mistake in judgment when he decided to invested all his money in that risky startup company.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (A)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The reporting verb said to changes to told when an object is present. The embedded statement He admitted that... is retained, and had made remains in the past perfect. Option D is incorrect because decided to must be followed by the base form invest, not invested.

Grammar Rules:

Said to + object → Told + object.

Decide to + base verb.

Admit that + clause.

EXAMPLE

Example: She said to me, "He has completed the work." → She told me that he had completed the work.

Q25. Arrange the following sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.

A. As part of this transformation, AI-powered tools can now detect diseases like cancer at much earlier stages than traditional methods

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B. Artificial Intelligence is rapidly transforming the healthcare industry.

C. Because of this ability, the technology also helps doctors personalize treatment plans based on patient data.

D. However, despite these advantages, concerns about data privacy and ethical use remain significant challenges.

(A) B-A-C-D

(B) A-B-D-C

(C) D-C-B-A

(D) C-D-A-B

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✓ **Correct Answer: (A) B-A-C-D**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Sentence B introduces the topic. Sentence A provides an example of AI's impact, sentence C explains a further benefit, and sentence D concludes by presenting the challenges.

Sequence: Introduction → Application → Additional benefit → Challenges.

EXAM TIP Words such as this transformation and this ability refer to ideas introduced in preceding sentences. The connector however often signals a contrast or qualification.

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DATE **6 October 2026**

SSC CGL 2026 English Questions — 6 October 2026

Q1. PREPOSITIONS

The following sentence has two blanks. Choose the most suitable set of prepositions.

The cat suddenly jumped ____ the table and knocked ____ the cup.

(a) into, off

(b) onto, over

(c) through, at

(d) along, on

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) onto, over**

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✦ EXPLANATION

"Onto" indicates movement to a surface, while "knock over" means to cause something to fall.

Jump onto the table.

Knock over a cup.

Topic: Prepositions and phrasal verbs

Q2. SENTENCE REARRANGEMENT

Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.

S1. Epigenetic modifications represent heritable changes in gene expression that occur without alterations to underlying DNA sequences.

A. These mechanisms enable organisms to respond dynamically to environmental stimuli while maintaining genomic stability.

B. Environmental factors including nutrition, stress, and toxin exposure can induce persistent epigenetic alterations.

C. DNA methylation and histone modifications constitute primary epigenetic regulatory mechanisms.

D. Emerging research suggests that certain epigenetic marks may be transmitted across generations, influencing offspring phenotypes.

(a) CABD

(b) BCDA

(c) DACB

(d) ABCD

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) CABD**

✦ EXPLANATION

C introduces the principal mechanisms of epigenetic regulation. A refers to these mechanisms, B explains how environmental factors influence epigenetic alterations, and D concludes with their possible transmission across generations.

Topic: Para Jumbles

Q3. DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH

Choose the correct indirect narration.

William said to Margaret, "You are now twenty-one years old and you cannot behave like a child."

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(a) William told Margaret that she was then twenty-one years old and she could not behave like a child.

(b) William told Margaret that she is then twenty-one years old and she could not behave like a child.

(c) William told Margaret that she is now twenty-one years old and she could not behave like a child.

(d) William told Margaret that she was now twenty-one years old and she could not behave like a child.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a)**

✦ EXPLANATION

In reported speech, the present tense generally shifts to the past when the reporting verb is in the past. "You" changes to "she," "are" to "was," "cannot" to "could not," and "now" to "then."

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

Q4. ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICE

Select the correct passive voice.

The tiger ate all the flesh that the zoo-keeper had kept in the enclosure.

(a) All the flesh that had been kept by the zoo-keeper in the enclosure was eaten by the tiger.

(b) All the flesh that was kept by the zoo-keeper in the enclosure was eaten by the tiger.

(c) All the flesh that had been kept by the zoo-keeper in the enclosure had been eaten by the tiger.

(d) All the flesh that was kept by the zoo-keeper in the enclosure had been eaten by the tiger.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The main clause is in the simple past: "ate" becomes "was eaten." The relative clause uses the past perfect: "had kept" becomes "had been kept."

Topic: Active and Passive Voice

Cloze Test

Directions: Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option for each blank.

Popular culture often celebrates leaders who exude unshakeable confidence, mistakenly equating (1)_____ with competence.

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sometimes dismissed as weak or indecisive. Yet a growing body of research suggests that this perception may be fundamentally misguided.

Studies of organisational behaviour reveal that intellectually humble leaders, those willing to concede the limits of their knowledge, frequently foster more innovative and resilient teams. By openly soliciting dissenting views, such leaders create an environment in which employees feel emboldened to voice unconventional ideas without fear of (2)_____. In contrast, autocratic managers who brook no disagreement often find themselves surrounded by sycophants, insulated from the unpalatable truths essential for sound decision-making.

Humility, however, should not be conflated with (3)_____. A humble leader is not one who vacillates endlessly or abdicates responsibility; rather, it is one who weighs evidence judiciously before acting decisively. The distinction is subtle but crucial, for excessive self-effacement can be as detrimental as arrogance.

The most (4)_____ leaders, it appears, strike a delicate balance between conviction and openness. They possess the fortitude to make difficult choices while retaining the magnanimity to revise those choices when confronted with compelling new information. Such adaptability is especially invaluable in an era of rapid technological and economic flux.

Cultivating this balance is no trivial undertaking. It demands introspection, a (5)_____ for honest feedback and the courage to admit error publicly, qualities that, paradoxically, reveal genuine strength rather than weakness.

Q5. **BLANK 1**

(a) bravado

(b) diffidence

(c) timidity

(d) humility

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) bravado**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Bravado means exaggerated confidence or a bold display intended to impress others. The passage describes the mistaken equation of outward confidence with competence.

VOCABULARY:

Bravado — exaggerated confidence

Diffidence — lack of self-confidence

Timidity — lack of courage

Humility — modesty

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

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Q6. BLANK 2

(a) accolade

(b) commendation

(c) reprisal

(d) remuneration

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) reprisal**

✦ EXPLANATION

Reprisal means retaliation or punishment in response to an action. Employees should be able to express unconventional ideas without fear of retaliation.

VOCABULARY:

Accolade — an award or expression of praise

Commendation — formal praise

Reprisal — retaliation

Remuneration — payment for work

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

Q7. BLANK 3

(a) sagacity

(b) probity

(c) tenacity

(d) irresolution

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) irresolution**

✦ EXPLANATION

Irresolution means indecisiveness or an inability to make a firm decision. The passage distinguishes humility from endless hesitation.

VOCABULARY:

Sagacity — wisdom and good judgment

Probity — honesty and integrity

Tenacity — persistence

Irresolution — indecisiveness

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

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Q8. BLANK 4

(a) obdurate

(b) efficacious

(c) ineffectual

(d) capricious

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) efficacious**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Efficacious means effective in producing the desired result. The passage describes leaders who balance conviction with openness and adaptability.

VOCABULARY:

Obdurate — stubborn and unwilling to change

Efficacious — effective

Ineffectual — ineffective

Capricious — unpredictable or impulsive

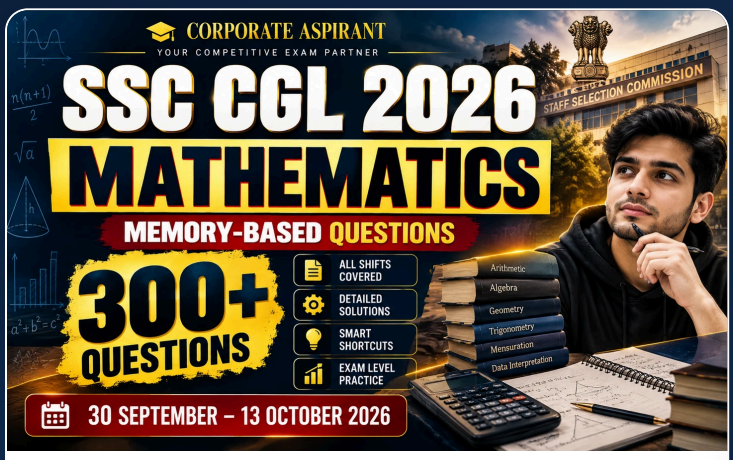
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Q9. BLANK 5

(a) aversion

(b) antipathy

(c) penchant

(d) disdain

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) penchant**

✦ EXPLANATION

Penchant for means a strong liking or inclination towards something. “A penchant for honest feedback” fits the sentence.

VOCABULARY:

Aversion — strong dislike

Antipathy — deep-seated dislike

Penchant — strong liking

Disdain — contempt

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

Q10. ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTION

What is the one-word substitute for “A genetic condition where a cell has only one copy of a particular chromosome instead of a pair”?

(a) Monosomy

(b) Trisomy

(c) Polyploidy

(d) Aneuploidy

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Monosomy**

✦ EXPLANATION

Monosomy is the condition in which one chromosome from a normally occurring pair is missing.

Exam Trap:

Monosomy: One chromosome of a pair is missing.

Trisomy: An extra chromosome is present, making three copies of a particular chromosome.

Polyploidy: More than two complete sets of chromosomes.

Aneuploidy: An abnormal chromosome number caused by the gain or loss of individual chromosomes.

Topic: One-Word Substitution

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Q11. SPELLING

Choose the correctly spelt word.

(a) Archetypal

(b) Archetypale

(c) Archtypal

(d) Archetypeal

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Archetypal**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Archetypal means representing a typical or original model of something.

EXAMPLE

Example: The wise mentor is an archetypal character in many stories.

Topic: Spelling

Q12. ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICE

Select the correct passive voice of the following sentence.

Suruchi exclaimed that the fish possessed a very big dorsal fin.

(a) It was exclaimed by Suruchi that a very big dorsal fin was possessed by the fish.

(b) It was exclaimed by Suruchi that a very big dorsal fin had been possessed by the fish.

(c) Suruchi exclaimed that a very big dorsal fin is possessed by the fish.

(d) It exclaimed Suruchi that a very big dorsal fin was possessed by the fish.

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Answer Given in the Source: (a)

✦ EXPLANATION

Option (a) is the answer provided in the source. However, the sentence is an awkward construction for a voice-conversion question because “exclaimed that” introduces a reported clause, rather than a straightforward transitive construction. The supplied answer should therefore be treated with caution.

Topic: Active and Passive Voice

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Q13. ERROR SPOTTING

Identify the part containing the error.

The ruling party (A) / stood for implementation (B) / of the bill and was ready (C) / to stake their political existence. (D)

(a) A

(b) B

(c) C

(d) D

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✓ **Correct Answer: (d) D**

✦ EXPLANATION

"The ruling party" is treated as a singular collective noun in this sentence. The possessive pronoun should therefore be "its," not "their."

Corrected sentence: The ruling party stood for implementation of the bill and was ready to stake its political existence.

Topic: Error Spotting — Pronoun Agreement

Q14. ANTONYM

Choose the word opposite in meaning to JETTISON.

(a) Accept

(b) Reward

(c) Dump

(d) Consent

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Accept**

✦ EXPLANATION

Jettison means to abandon, discard, or throw something away. "Accept" is the closest opposite among the given options.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Jettison — discard or abandon | Retain — keep | Abandon — give up | Discard — throw away

Topic: Antonyms

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Q15. SPELLING

Choose the option with the correct spelling.

(a) Warcestesire

(b) Worcestershire

(c) Worcestersire

(d) Warcesteshire

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Worcestershire**

✦ EXPLANATION

Worcestershire is the correct spelling of the English county and is also known from Worcestershire sauce.

Topic: Spelling

Q16. ERROR SPOTTING

Identify the part of the sentence containing an error.

He figured that to find a decent drum he had to go to a large flea market that is in a major city and usually gives place on weekends.

(a) He figured that to find a decent

(b) drum he had to go to a large flea

(c) market that is in a major city and

(d) usually gives place on weekends.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (d)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The phrase “gives place” is incorrect in this context. The intended expression is “takes place,” meaning that an event occurs.

Corrected sentence: He figured that to find a decent drum he had to go to a large flea market that is in a major city and usually takes place on weekends.

Topic: Error Spotting — Idiomatic Usage

Q17. IDIOM

Choose the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiom.

The new employee proved to be a dark horse by performing exceptionally well in the project.

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(a) Proved to be an average performer

(b) A person who has skills or abilities that are not known to others

(c) A person who betrays others

(d) A person who is loud and overconfident

✓ Correct Answer: (b)

✦ **EXPLANATION**

A dark horse is a person whose abilities or potential are not widely known but who achieves unexpected success.

EXAMPLE

Example: The relatively unknown candidate emerged as a dark horse in the competition.

Topic: Idioms and Phrases

Q18. **ANTONYM**

Choose the correct antonym of PRIVY.

(a) Covert

(b) Personal

(c) Private

(d) Unconcealed

✓ Correct Answer: (d) Unconcealed

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Privy can mean private, secret, or having knowledge of something confidential. “Unconcealed,” meaning open or not hidden, is the closest opposite among the given options.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Privy — having private or confidential knowledge

Covert — secret or concealed

Unconcealed — open or not hidden

Topic: Antonyms

Q19. **SENTENCE REARRANGEMENT**

Arrange the following sentences in a logical sequence to form a coherent paragraph.

A. The technique involves controlled cooling processes that induce specific crystalline structures, enhancing material

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B. Metallurgical advancements in alloy composition have revolutionized aerospace engineering applications.

C. These innovations enable aircraft components to withstand extreme temperatures while maintaining structural integrity.

D. Contemporary manufacturers employ sophisticated heat treatment methodologies to optimize mechanical characteristics.

(a) BADC

(b) BDAC

(c) DCAB

(d) ABCD

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) BDAC**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

B introduces metallurgical advancements in aerospace engineering. D explains the use of heat-treatment methodologies, A describes the technique, and C concludes with the resulting benefits for aircraft components.

Topic: Para Jumbles

Q20. SENTENCE REARRANGEMENT

Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.

A. Implementing robust data governance frameworks necessitates cross-functional collaboration among stakeholders to ensure compliance and accountability.

B. However, the exponential proliferation of unstructured data poses formidable challenges to traditional data management paradigms.

C. Organizations increasingly recognize that data constitutes a strategic asset requiring meticulous stewardship and protection.

D. Consequently, enterprises are investing substantially in advanced analytics platforms and automated compliance mechanisms.

(a) CBDA

(b) ACBD

(c) BDAC

(d) CADB

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) CBDA**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

C introduces the importance of data as a strategic asset. B presents the challenge posed by unstructured data, D describes the resulting investments, and A explains the governance and collaboration needed to ensure compliance and accountability.

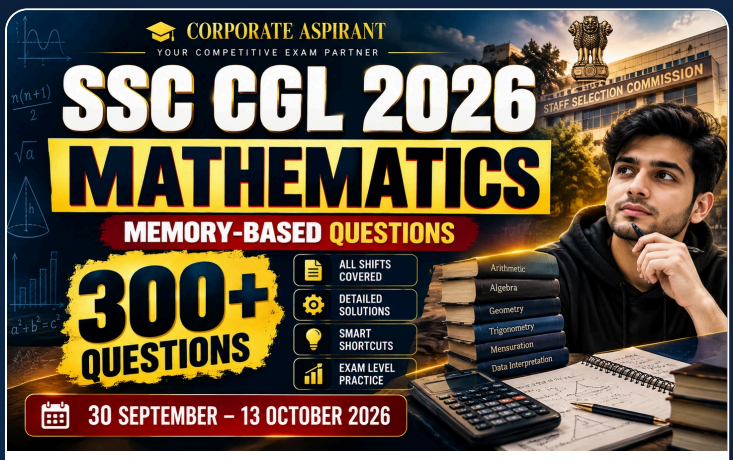
Topic: Para Jumbles

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Q21. HOMONYMS

Which pair of homonyms can be used to fill in the blanks most suitably?

During his ____ from the snowy peak, he thought about his ____ from a long line of mountaineers.

(a) descent, descent

(b) descent, dissent

(c) dissent, descent

(d) dissent, dissent

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) descent, descent**

✦ EXPLANATION

Both blanks require “descent,” but the word is used in two related senses.

Descent: The act of moving down from a height.

Descent: An individual's ancestry or lineage.

“Dissent” means disagreement and does not fit either blank.

Topic: Homonyms and Vocabulary

Q22. SYNONYM

Select the most appropriate synonym of JEJUNE.

(a) Kind

(b) Boring

(c) Young

(d) Curious

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Boring**

✦ EXPLANATION

Jejune means dull, simplistic, immature, or lacking substance. “Boring” is the closest option in this context.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Jejune — dull or simplistic

Tedious — tiresome or boring

Trite — lacking originality

Superficial — lacking depth

Topic: Synonyms

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Q23. SENTENCE REARRANGEMENT

Reorder the sentences to form a cohesive and logically structured passage.

A. A sunrise sector has become a sunset sector in less than a decade, with a revenue model which has no relationship to influence, trust and reach.

B. One of the defining lessons I have learnt as a journalist in the last three decades is actually a life skill that one could deploy in any sector.

C. It is about navigating change while retaining your core values and cardinal principles.

D. Technology is galloping at an exponential rate; geopolitics is always shifting; and what was ...

(a) CBDA

(b) BCDA

(c) ADBC

(d) DBAC

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) BCDA**

✦ EXPLANATION

B introduces the journalist's central lesson. C explains that lesson, D introduces the rapidly changing environment, and A provides an example of how quickly a sector can change.

Source note: Sentence D appears incomplete in the supplied question text. The intended sequence is retained according to the provided answer, but the missing continuation should be checked against the original paper.

Topic: Para Jumbles

Q24. IDIOM

Choose the most appropriate meaning of STRAW IN THE WIND.

(a) A sign or indication of what may happen in the future

(b) A useless and worthless object

(c) A difficult situation requiring courage

(d) An unexpected and dangerous event

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a)**

✦ EXPLANATION

A straw in the wind is a small sign or indication that suggests a possible future development.

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EXAMPLE

Example: The minister's latest statement may be a straw in the wind indicating a change in policy.

Topic: Idioms and Phrases

Q25. SENTENCE REARRANGEMENT

Reorder the sentences to form a cohesive and logically structured passage.

Opening sentence: The presidents of the New York Central and the New York, New Haven and Hartford railroads will swear on a stack of timetables that there are only two.

A. But I say there are three, because I've been on the third level of the Grand Central Station.

B. Yes, I've taken the obvious step: I talked to a psychiatrist friend of mine, among others.

C. I told him about the third level at Grand Central Station, and he said it was a waking-dream wish fulfillment. He said I was unhappy.

D. That made my wife kind of mad, but he explained that he meant the modern world is full of insecurity, fear, war, worry and all the rest of it, and that I just want to escape.

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(a) ACBD

(b) ACDB

(c) BDAC

(d) DBAC

Answer Given in the Source: (b) ACDB

Explanation and source verification: The supplied answer is (b), but the sequence appears inconsistent with the passage's logic. B introduces the conversation with the psychiatrist; C refers to telling "him" about the third level; D continues the psychiatrist's explanation. Therefore, B should logically precede C, and C should precede D. The provided options do not offer a clearly coherent sequence that preserves this order after the opening sentence.

DATE **7 October 2026**

SSC CGL 2026 English Questions — 7 October 2026

Q1. SENTENCE REARRANGEMENT

Given below are some jumbled sentences. Pick the one that gives their correct order.

(1) of space scientists of India, which provides platform to the researchers in space sciences

(2) to exchange the scientific results, review the scientific lessons learnt from the previous missions

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(a) 2134

(b) 3124

(c) 4132

(d) 3412

Correct Answer: (b) 3124

EXPLANATION

Sentence 3 introduces the National Space Science Symposium. Sentence 1 describes its role, sentence 2 continues by explaining its purpose, and sentence 4 gives information about the event's inauguration.

Topic: Para Jumbles

Q2.

SENTENCE REARRANGEMENT

Arrange the following sentences in the correct order.

(1) In its second developmental flight, the SSLV-D2 vehicle placed EOS-07, Janus-1 and AzaadiSAT-2 satellites into their intended 450 km circular orbit with an inclination of 37 degrees.

(2) Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV) successfully launched three satellites into their intended orbits.

(3) and took about 15 minutes to inject the satellites.

(4) It took off from the first launch pad at Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota, at 09:18 hours IST.

(a) 2134

(b) 1324

(c) 2143

(d) 3124

Correct Answer: (c) 2143

EXPLANATION

Sentence 2 introduces the successful launch. Sentence 1 identifies the mission and satellites, sentence 4 provides the launch location and time, and sentence 3 completes the description of the mission duration.

Topic: Para Jumbles

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Q3. SYNONYM

Select the most appropriate synonym of ZEALOUS.

(a) Envious

(b) Impersonal

(c) Enthusiastic

(d) Formal

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) Enthusiastic**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Zealous means showing great enthusiasm, energy, or dedication towards a cause or activity.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Zealous — enthusiastic and dedicated

Fervent — intensely passionate

Ardent — enthusiastic and passionate

Diligent — hardworking and careful

Topic: Synonyms

Q4. ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICE

Select the correct passive voice.

The chef has prepared a very sweet dish to serve the dignitaries in the reception.

(a) A very sweet dish to be served to the dignitaries in the reception has been prepared by the chef.

(b) A very sweet dish to be serve to the dignitaries in the reception has been prepared by the chef.

(c) A very sweet dish to served to the dignitaries in the reception has been prepared by the chef.

(d) A very sweet dish to serve to the dignitaries in the reception is prepared by the chef.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The present perfect tense changes from “has prepared” to “has been prepared” in the passive voice. The infinitive phrase becomes “to be served.”

Rule: Present perfect passive = has/have + been + past participle.

Topic: Active and Passive Voice

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Q5. IDIOM

Select the most appropriate meaning of GIVE SOMEONE THE SLIP.

(a) To flatter others

(b) To neglect someone

(c) To give a notice

(d) To escape from someone

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) To escape from someone**

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✦ EXPLANATION

To give someone the slip means to escape from someone who is following, watching, or trying to catch you.

EXAMPLE

Example: The suspect gave the police the slip in the crowded market.

Topic: Idioms and Phrases

Q6. SPELLING

Which word is spelt incorrectly?

(a) Conscientious

(b) Indispensable

(c) Reconnassance

(d) Entrepreneur

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) Reconnassance**

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✦ EXPLANATION

The correct spelling is Reconnaissance, meaning a preliminary survey or investigation to gather information.

Topic: Spelling

Q7. PARA JUMBLES

Arrange the sentences to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.

P. In addition, these ancient manuscripts provide profound insights into human consciousness.

Q. Therefore, modern scholars continue to analyze these texts for timeless wisdom.

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S. However, translating these complex Sanskrit verses remains a very difficult task.

(a) RPSQ

(b) QSPR

(c) PRSQ

(d) SQRP

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) RPSQ**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

R introduces ancient Indian scriptures. P adds another benefit of these manuscripts, S introduces the difficulty of translating them, and Q concludes by explaining why scholars continue to study them.

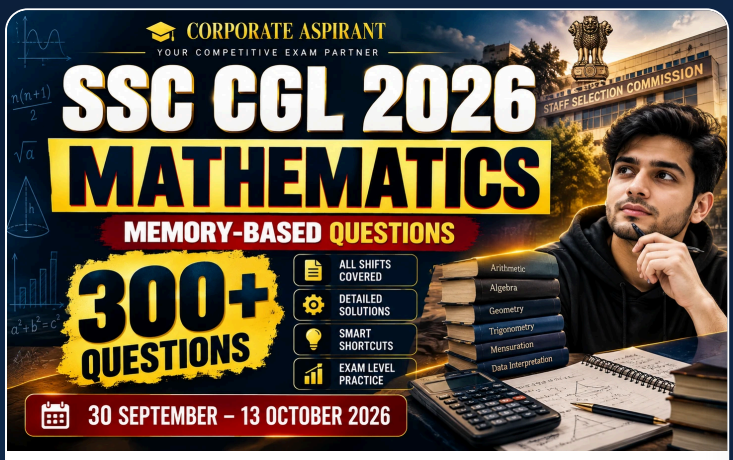
Topic: Para Jumbles

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Q8. ACTIVE VOICE

Change the following sentence into the active form.

His application had been looked over by a special committee for weeks.

(a) A special committee has looked over his application for weeks.

(b) A special committee was looking over his application for weeks.

(c) A special committee had been looking over his application for weeks.

(d) His application was looked over by a special committee.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (c)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The passive construction uses the past perfect continuous tense. The active form is "had been looking over."

Rule: Past perfect continuous active = subject + had been + verb-ing.

Topic: Active and Passive Voice

Q9. ANTONYM

Select the most appropriate antonym of ARDUOUS.

(a) Grueling

(b) Exhausting

(c) Effortless

(d) Tedious

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✓ **Correct Answer: (c) Effortless**

✦ EXPLANATION

Arduous means requiring considerable effort and being difficult or tiring. Effortless means requiring little or no effort.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Arduous — difficult and demanding

Grueling — extremely tiring

Tedious — boring and lengthy

Effortless — easy to accomplish

Topic: Antonyms

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Q10. PARA JUMBLES

Rearrange the following sentence parts to form a meaningful and grammatically correct paragraph.

P. She poured the hot liquid into her favourite mug.

Q. A downpour had started raining hard, beating against the windowpanes in a steady rhythm.

R. The kitchen was filled with the scent of cinnamon and cloves, a comforting and warm smell.

S. It was a fantastic night to have a mug of hot cider.

(a) RQPS

(b) QSRP

(c) SPQR

(d) RPQS

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) QSRP**

✦ EXPLANATION

Q establishes the rainy setting. S introduces the idea of drinking hot cider, R describes the kitchen's atmosphere, and P concludes with the action of pouring the drink.

Topic: Para Jumbles

Q11. ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTION

Select the one-word substitute for:

"Very determined and refusing to be defeated by problems."

(a) Vociferous

(b) Impetuous

(c) Imprudent

(d) Pertinacious

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✓ **Correct Answer: (d) Pertinacious**

✦ EXPLANATION

Pertinacious means persistent and determined, especially when holding firmly to an opinion or course of action.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Pertinacious — persistent and determined

Vociferous — loud and forceful

Impetuous — acting without careful thought

Imprudent — lacking judgment

Topic: One-Word Substitution

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Q12. SPELLING

Choose the correctly spelt word.

(a) Facsimile

(b) Facsmile

(c) Facsimily

(d) Facsimele

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Facsimile**

✦ EXPLANATION

Facsimile means an exact copy or reproduction of a document, image, or other material.

Topic: Spelling

Cloze Test

Directions: Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option for each blank.

For centuries, the Silk Road served as far more than a conduit for commodities; it was a vibrant artery through which ideas, beliefs and technologies flowed between civilisations. Merchants traversing its (1)_____ terrain, which included scorching deserts, treacherous mountain passes and desolate steppes, carried not merely silk and spices but also philosophies that would profoundly reshape the societies they touched.

The exchange was remarkably (2)_____. Buddhism journeyed eastward from India into China, while papermaking techniques gradually migrated westward, eventually transforming scholarship in the Islamic world and Europe. Such cross-pollination fostered a cosmopolitan ethos in bustling entrepots like Samarkand and Kashgar, where polyglot traders haggled in myriad tongues.

Yet the route was not without its perils. Brigands lay in wait for (3)_____ caravans, and the vicissitudes of politics could abruptly sever vital links. The collapse of a single empire often precipitated a decline in commerce across vast regions, illustrating how interdependent these far-flung economies had become.

Historians caution against romanticising this era, noting that disease, too, travelled along these pathways; the Black Death is widely believed to have spread partly through such networks. Nonetheless, the Silk Road's legacy remains (4)_____. It demonstrates that human progress has seldom been the achievement of isolated societies but rather the fruit of sustained interaction.

In today's increasingly insular political climate, this lesson acquires fresh (5)_____. Nations contemplating a retreat behind protectionist barriers would do well to remember that prosperity has historically flourished where borders were porous and minds were receptive.

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Q13. BLANK 1

(a) Hospitable

(b) Placid

(c) Inhospitable

(d) Verdant

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) Inhospitable**

✦ EXPLANATION

Inhospitable means harsh or unsuitable for living or travelling. It fits the description of scorching deserts, dangerous mountain passes, and desolate steppes.

Q14. BLANK 2

(a) Unilateral

(b) Reciprocal

(c) Desultory

(d) Parochial

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Reciprocal**

✦ EXPLANATION

Reciprocal means mutual or involving both sides. The passage describes the exchange of ideas and technologies between civilisations.

Q15. BLANK 3

(a) Vigilant

(b) Circumspect

(c) Indomitable

(d) Unwary

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) Unwary**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Unwary means not cautious or alert to danger. Such caravans would be vulnerable to attacks by brigands.

Q16. BLANK 4

(a) Ephemeral

(b) Indelible

(c) Nebulous

(d) Inconsequential

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Indelible**

✦ EXPLANATION

Indelible means impossible to erase or forget. The word conveys the lasting impact of the Silk Road.

Q17. BLANK 5

(a) Resonance

(b) Obsolescence

(c) Irrelevance

(d) Ambiguity

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Resonance**

✦ EXPLANATION

Resonance refers to significance or relevance. The lesson of the Silk Road has renewed relevance in the current political climate.

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

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Q18. SPELLING

One of these words is spelt incorrectly. Which one?

(a) Euphemism

(b) Fractious

(c) Willful

(d) Supplecation

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) Supplecation**

✦ EXPLANATION

The correct spelling is Supplication, meaning a humble or earnest request.

Topic: Spelling

Q19. ANTONYM

Select the correct antonym of REBUKE.

(a) Repulse

(b) Admonish

(c) Applaud

(d) Reprimand

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) Applaud**

✦ EXPLANATION

Rebuke means to criticize or scold someone sharply. Applaud means to express approval or praise.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Rebuke — scold or criticize

Admonish — warn or reprimand

Reprimand — formally criticize

Applaud — praise or approve

Topic: Antonyms

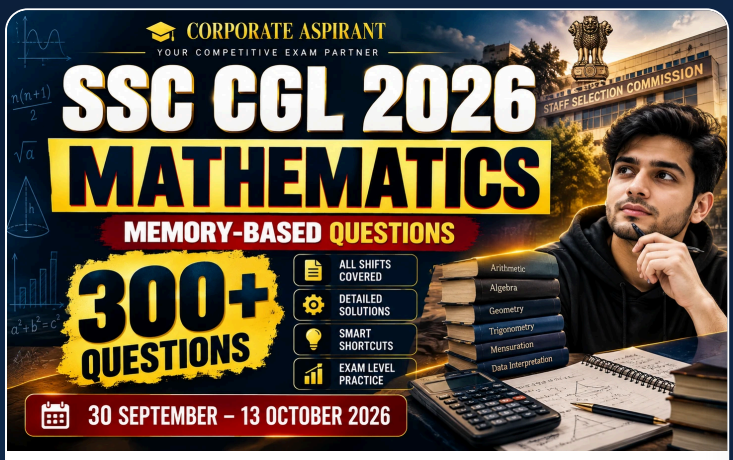
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Q20. HOMONYMS

Choose the correctly used word in the sentence.

(a) She has a flair for baking.

(b) He tied the flag to the flaire.

(c) They built a flair to signal help.

(d) She used a flare pen to write.

✓ **Correct Answer: (a)**

✦ EXPLANATION

Flair means a natural talent or aptitude. In contrast, flare means a sudden burst of light or fire, or something that spreads outward.

Flair: She has a flair for languages.

Flare: The emergency flare lit up the sky.

Topic: Homonyms and Commonly Confused Words

Q21. ERROR SPOTTING

Identify the part containing an error.

One of the most difficult problem / that the organisation faces / is the evasion of contribution by small establishments.

(a) One of the most difficult problem

(b) that the organisation faces

(c) is the evasion of contribution by small establishments

(d) No error

✓ **Correct Answer: (a)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The phrase “one of the most” is followed by a plural noun. Therefore, “problem” should be changed to “problems.”

Corrected Sentence: One of the most difficult problems that the organisation faces is the evasion of contribution by small establishments.

Rule: One of the + adjective phrase + plural noun.

Topic: Error Spotting — Noun Agreement

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Q22. ERROR SPOTTING

Identify the part containing an error.

No sooner did the Commissioner enter the hall / than the members rose from their seats / and greeted him with a loud applause.

(a) No sooner did the Commissioner enter the hall

(b) than the members rose from their seats

(c) and greeted him with a loud applause

(d) No error

✓ **Correct Answer: (c)**

✦ EXPLANATION

Applause is an uncountable noun and is not normally preceded by "a." The correct expressions are "with loud applause" or "with a loud round of applause."

Corrected Sentence: No sooner did the Commissioner enter the hall than the members rose from their seats and greeted him with loud applause.

Rule: "No sooner" is generally paired with "than."

Topic: Error Spotting — Articles and Idiomatic Usage

Q23. PARA JUMBLES

Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.

A. This field allows scientists to design and construct new biological parts and systems.

B. Synthetic biology is an emerging discipline that combines biology with engineering principles.

C. Applications range from creating new medicines to developing sustainable biofuels.

D. It holds immense potential to solve some of humanity's biggest challenges.

(a) B – A – C – D

(b) B – C – A – D

(c) A – B – C – D

(d) D – B – A – C

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) B – A – C – D**

✦ EXPLANATION

B introduces synthetic biology. A explains what the field enables scientists to do, C gives examples of applications, and D

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Topic: Para Jumbles

Q24. IDIOM

Select the most appropriate meaning of RED LETTER DAY.

(a) Memorable day

(b) Rose day

(c) Holiday

(d) Birthday

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Memorable day**

✦ EXPLANATION

A red-letter day is a particularly important, happy, or memorable day.

EXAMPLE

Example: Receiving his appointment letter was a red-letter day in his life.

Topic: Idioms and Phrases

Q25. DIRECT SPEECH

Choose the most appropriate conversion into direct speech.

She said that they would have left the town and moved to Pune by the following week.

(a) She said, "They will have left the town and moved to Pune by next week."

(b) She said, "That they would leave the town and move to Pune by next week."

(c) She said, "They have left the town and moved to Pune by the following week."

(d) She said, "They will leave the town and move to Pune by the following week."

✓ **Correct Answer: (a)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The reported future perfect construction “would have left” corresponds to “will have left” in direct speech when the original reporting context is restored. “The following week” may become “next week.”

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

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DATE **8 October 2026**

SSC CGL 2026 English Questions — 8 October 2026

Prepare for SSC CGL 2026 with these memory-based English questions covering vocabulary, cloze tests, grammar, para jumbles, idioms, spelling, and narration. Each question includes its answer and a short explanation for quick revision.

Q1. CLOZE TEST — VOCABULARY

Read the passage and select the most appropriate word to fill in Blank 1.

In an age increasingly enamored of instantaneous information, intellectual restraint has become an almost antiquated virtue. The contemporary reader is perpetually assailed by a prodigious volume of claims, conjectures, and polemics, many of which acquire an unwarranted aura of credibility merely through repetition. What is particularly disquieting is not the sheer abundance of information but the gradual erosion of the cognitive habits required to interrogate it. A proposition that ought to invite scrutiny is instead accepted with remarkable alacrity, while evidence that complicates an established conviction is frequently dismissed as an inconvenient (1)_____.

This tendency is exacerbated by digital platforms whose algorithms are designed less to cultivate discernment than to maximise engagement. By continuously presenting users with material consonant with their pre-existing preferences, such systems can create an epistemic environment that is deceptively (2). Within such an environment, disagreement is no longer perceived as an opportunity for intellectual refinement but as an affront to one's identity. Consequently, individuals become increasingly (3) to information that unsettles their assumptions, even when such information is supported by cogent evidence.

The predicament is further complicated by the proliferation of ostensibly authoritative voices whose expertise is difficult to verify. Eloquence, confidence, and rhetorical dexterity are often mistaken for substantive knowledge, allowing specious arguments to acquire an appearance of legitimacy. The resulting confusion is not merely (4)_____; it can have tangible consequences when poorly examined claims influence public policy, medical decisions, or collective perceptions of social reality.

The remedy, therefore, cannot consist simply in accumulating more information. What is required is a deliberate cultivation of intellectual habits that enable individuals to distinguish the plausible from the demonstrable, the persuasive from the (5)_____, and the familiar from the genuinely verifiable. In an informational ecosystem increasingly saturated with noise, scepticism—properly understood not as cynical disbelief but as disciplined inquiry—may be among the most indispensable forms of intellectual hygiene.

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OPTIONS:

(a) Exculpation

(b) Cavil

(c) Imputation

(d) Salience

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Cavil**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Cavil means a trivial or unnecessary objection. The sentence describes evidence being dismissed as an inconvenient objection rather than examined objectively.

VOCABULARY:

Cavil — a petty objection

Exculpation — the act of clearing someone from blame

Imputation — an attribution, often of blame

Salience — the quality of being noticeable or important

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

Q2. **CLOZE TEST — VOCABULARY**

Select the correct option to fill in Blank 2.

(a) Congruous

(b) Refractory

(c) Pellucid

(d) Censorious

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Congruous**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Congruous means compatible, consistent, or in agreement. Digital platforms repeatedly present information that agrees with users' existing preferences, creating an environment that feels consistent with their beliefs.

VOCABULARY:

Congruous — compatible or consistent

Refractory — stubborn or resistant to control

Pellucid — clear and easily understood

Censorious — severely critical of others

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

Q3. **CLOZE TEST — VOCABULARY**

Select the correct option to fill in Blank 3.

(a) Inimical

(b) Receptive

(c) Obsequious

(d) Impervious

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) Impervious**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Impervious to means unaffected by or not influenced by something. The sentence describes people who resist information that challenges their existing assumptions.

VOCABULARY:

Impervious — not affected or influenced | Inimical — harmful or hostile | Receptive — willing to consider new ideas | Obsequious — excessively submissive or eager to please

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

Q4. CLOZE TEST — VOCABULARY

Select the correct option to fill in Blank 4.

(a) Innocuous

(b) Recondite

(c) Pernicious

(d) Desultory

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Innocuous**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Innocuous means harmless or unlikely to cause damage. The sentence explains that the confusion is not merely harmless because it can have serious real-world consequences.

VOCABULARY:

Innocuous — harmless | Recondite — difficult to understand | Pernicious — extremely harmful | Desultory — lacking a clear plan or purpose

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

Q5. CLOZE TEST — VOCABULARY

Select the correct option to fill in Blank 5.

(a) Verisimilar

(b) Veracious

(c) Prolix

(d) Vituperative

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Veracious**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Veracious means truthful or accurate. The passage contrasts persuasive information with information that is genuinely truthful.

VOCABULARY:

Veracious — truthful | Verisimilar — appearing to be true | Prolix — unnecessarily lengthy | Vituperative — bitterly abusive or critical

Topic: Cloze Test and Vocabulary

Q6. **SYNONYM**

Select the most appropriate synonym of SUAVE.

(a) Urbane

(b) Prodigal

(c) Lament

(d) Nippy

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Urbane**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Suave means smooth, charming, and sophisticated in manner. Urbane means polished, courteous, and sophisticated.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Suave — charming and sophisticated | Urbane — polished and courteous | Prodigal — wasteful or extravagant | Lament — to express sorrow

Topic: Synonyms

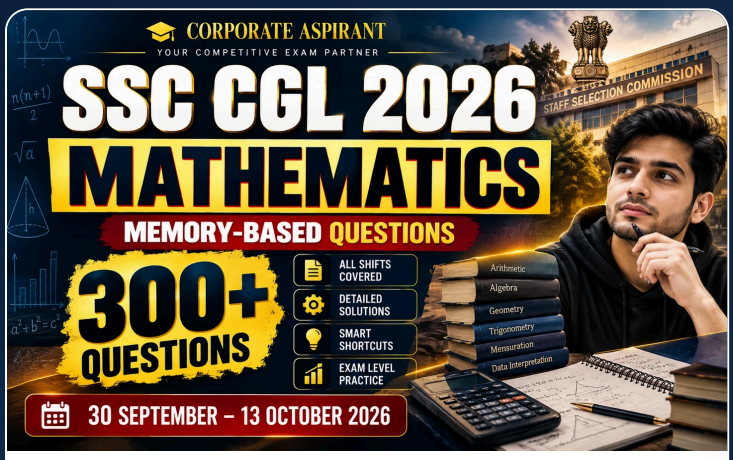
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Q7. IDIOM

Select the correct meaning of BE UP TO THE MINUTE.

(a) At the last possible instant or opportunity

(b) To wait or pause

(c) To be as current as is possible

(d) At a very rapid pace

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) To be as current as is possible**

✦ EXPLANATION

Up to the minute means completely up to date or containing the latest information.

EXAMPLE

Example: The website provides up-to-the-minute examination updates.

Topic: Idioms and Phrases

Q8. IDIOM

Which idiom means "eagerly, with great enthusiasm, or ready to enjoy oneself"?

(a) Bear the bell

(b) Passing bells

(c) With bells on

(d) Sound as a bell

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) With bells on**

✦ EXPLANATION

With bells on means to attend an event eagerly and enthusiastically.

EXAMPLE

Example: "Will you come to the party?" "Absolutely! I'll be there with bells on."

Topic: Idioms and Phrases

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Q9. ANTONYM

What is the antonym of IRASCIBLE?

(a) Petulant

(b) Tranquil

(c) Hostile

(d) Fractious

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Tranquil**

✦ EXPLANATION

Irascible means easily angered or having a quick temper. Tranquil means calm and peaceful.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Irascible — easily angered

Petulant — irritable or impatient

Fractious — unruly or irritable

Tranquil — calm and peaceful

Topic: Antonyms

Q10. DIRECT SPEECH

Choose the most appropriate conversion into direct speech.

The librarian requested us to maintain silence in the reading room.

(a) The librarian said to us, "Maintain silence in the reading room."

(b) The librarian said, "Please maintain silence in the reading room."

(c) The librarian told us, "Silence should be maintained in the reading room."

(d) The librarian requested, "You can maintain silence in the reading room."

✓ **Correct Answer: (b)**

✦ EXPLANATION

A polite request in indirect speech is commonly expressed using “Please” in direct speech.

Rule: Requested + object + to-infinitive can be converted into a polite imperative using “Please.”

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

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Q11. DIRECT SPEECH

Select the correct direct narration.

Shivi told Rahul that he had realized that the mysterious footprints in the snow were actually made by a very large neighborhood dog.

(a) Shivi said to Rahul, "He realized that the mysterious footprints in the snow were actually made by a very large neighborhood dog."

(b) Shivi said to Rahul, "He realizes that the mysterious footprints in the snow were actually made by a very large neighborhood dog."

(c) Shivi said to Rahul, "He realized that the mysterious footprints in the snow had been actually made by a very large neighborhood dog."

(d) Shivi said to Rahul, "He realized that the mysterious footprints in the snow were actually made from a very large neighborhood dog."

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The past perfect "had realized" can revert to the simple past "realized" when converting back to direct speech. "Made by" is the correct expression for identifying the agent.

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

Q12. SPELLING

Choose the correctly spelt word to replace the highlighted word.

His actions were considered an anathima to the entire community, leading to his exile.

(a) Anethema

(b) Anathama

(c) Anathema

(d) No replacement required

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✓ **Correct Answer: (c) Anathema**

✦ EXPLANATION

Anathema means something or someone intensely disliked or regarded as unacceptable.

EXAMPLE

Example: Corruption is anathema to an honest administration.

Topic: Spelling and Vocabulary

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Q13. ACTIVE VOICE

Choose the most appropriate conversion into active voice.

The victims were provided food and shelter by the volunteers.

(a) The volunteers were providing food and shelter to the victims.

(b) The volunteers have provided food and shelter to the victims.

(c) The volunteers provide food and shelter to the victims.

(d) The volunteers provided food and shelter to the victims.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (d)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The passive sentence is in the simple past tense: “were provided.” In the active voice, the subject becomes “the volunteers,” and the verb becomes “provided.”

Rule: Simple past passive = was/were + past participle.

Simple past active = subject + past-tense verb.

Topic: Active and Passive Voice

Q14. PARA JUMBLES

Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful paragraph.

In today's fast-paced world, it can be easy to feel disconnected from others.

That's why it's important to make time for face-to-face interactions with friends and loved ones.

Social media and technology have made it easier than ever to stay in touch, but they can also contribute to feelings of isolation.

By prioritizing these connections, we can improve our mental health and overall well-being.

(a) 1324

(b) 1234

(c) 3124

(d) 1423

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) 1324**

✦ EXPLANATION

Sentence 1 introduces the problem of social disconnection. Sentence 3 explains how technology can contribute to isolation. Sentence 2 offers a solution, and sentence 4 concludes with its benefits.

Topic: Para Jumbles

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Q15. PARA JUMBLES

Arrange the following sentences in the correct order.

A. One of the earliest known vacuum cleaners was so large that it had to be hauled from house to house.

B. Its giant hoses were popped through the windows of customers.

C. Vacuum cleaners were originally horse-drawn.

D. A gas-powered motor generated the suction that pulled the dirt and debris into a glass container where onlookers could gawk at the volume of filth coming from their neighbours' homes.

(a) CBDA

(b) CDAB

(c) CABD

(d) CADB

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✓ **Correct Answer: (c) CABD**

✦ EXPLANATION

C introduces the original horse-drawn vacuum cleaners. A describes their enormous size, B explains how the hoses were used, and D elaborates on the mechanism and collection of dirt.

Topic: Para Jumbles

Q16. PASSIVE VOICE

Select the correct passive voice.

The usher must have made the guests sit by the time the dinner was ready.

(a) The guests must have been made sit by the usher by the time the dinner was ready.

(b) The guests must have been made to sit by the usher by the time the dinner was ready.

(c) The guests must have been made to sit by the usher by the time the dinner had been ready.

(d) The guests must have made to sit by the usher by the time the dinner had been ready.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b)**

✦ EXPLANATION

In active voice, “make” is followed by an object and the base form of the verb: “made the guests sit.” In passive voice, “made” is followed by “to + verb.”

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Rule: Active: make + object + base verb.

Passive: object + be made + to-infinitive.

Topic: Active and Passive Voice

Q17. ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTION

What is the term for a government controlled by monopolists?

(a) Oligarchy

(b) Plutocracy

(c) Autocracy

(d) Plutonomy

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Plutocracy**

✦ EXPLANATION

Plutocracy refers to a system of government in which wealthy people exercise dominant political power.

Related Terms:

Oligarchy — government by a small group

Plutocracy — government dominated by the wealthy

Autocracy — government by one person with supreme power

Plutonomy — an economy driven by wealthy consumers

Topic: One-Word Substitution and Political Vocabulary

Q18. ERROR SPOTTING

Identify the part containing a grammatical error.

The investigative committee / decided to look into / the irregularities and eventually / looked them over carefully.

(a) The investigative committee

(b) decided to look into

(c) the irregularities and eventually

(d) looked them over carefully

✓ **Answer: (d), as indicated by the question's answer key**

✦ EXPLANATION

"Look into" means to investigate, while "look over" means to examine or inspect. In this sentence, the two expressions are used together to describe examining the irregularities.

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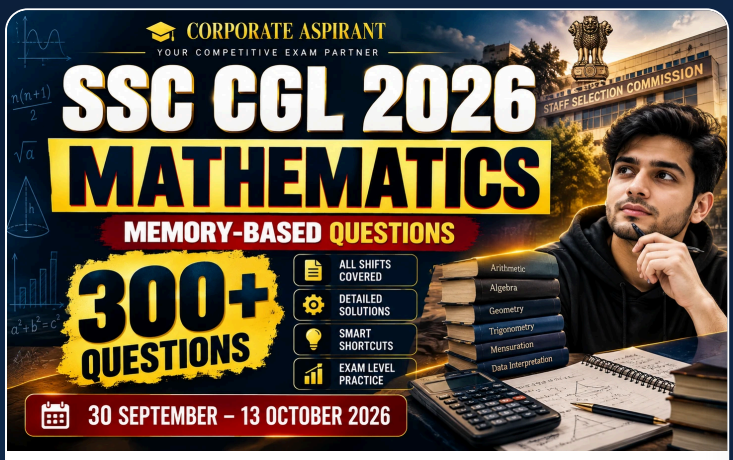
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Q19. PARA JUMBLES

Arrange the jumbled sentences in a logical sequence. S1 and S2 are fixed.

S1. Two days and two nights did Peter sleep without once awakening.

A. He looked; there were two bags of gold.

B. When he came to himself, on the third day, he looked long at all the corners of his hut but in vain did he endeavour to recollect what had taken place; his memory was like a miser's pocket from which you cannot entice a quarter of a kopek.

C. Stretching himself, he heard something clash at his feet.

D. Then only, as if in a dream, he recollected that he had been seeking for treasure and that something had frightened him in the woods.

S2. But at what price he had obtained it, and how, he could by no means tell.

(a) CADB

(b) BCAD

(c) ACDB

(d) CDBA

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) BCAD**

✦ EXPLANATION

B describes Peter regaining consciousness and trying to remember what happened. C follows with the sound he hears, A identifies the gold, and D explains his recollection of the events in the woods.

Topic: Para Jumbles

Q20. PARA JUMBLES

Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful paragraph.

A. The Voynich Manuscript is a 240-page medieval tome written in an unknown language that has baffled scholars and code-breakers for years.

B. All attempts to translate the book's text or identify the plants depicted in it have failed.

C. The manuscript is believed to have originated sometime between 1404 and 1438.

D. It is filled with enigmatic illustrations and diagrams that seem to depict everything from unusual plants to women with swollen bellies bathing in green pools.

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(a) ACDB

(b) ADBC

(c) ABDC

(d) ACBD

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) ACDB**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

A introduces the manuscript. C provides its estimated date, D describes its unusual illustrations, and B concludes by explaining that attempts to decipher it have been unsuccessful.

Topic: Para Jumbles

Q21. **SPELLING**

Choose the correctly spelt word.

(a) Playright

(b) Playrite

(c) Playwrite

(d) Playwright

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) Playwright**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

A playwright is a person who writes plays for the theatre.

Memory Tip: The word ends with “wright,” as in “write,” not “right.”

Topic: Spelling

Q22. **DIRECT SPEECH**

Choose the most appropriate conversion into direct speech.

He warned that if we did not act immediately, the consequences would be irreversible.

(a) He said, "If you didn't act immediately, the consequences will be irreversible."

(b) He said, "If you don't act immediately, the consequences will be irreversible."

(c) He said, "If you hadn't act immediately, the consequences would be irreversible."

(d) He said, "If you haven't act immediately, the consequences would be irreversible."

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

In direct speech, the original present-tense condition can be restored: “if you don't act.” The future consequence is expressed as “will be irreversible.”

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

Q23. INDIRECT SPEECH

Choose the correct indirect narration.

The trainer said to the trainees, "Go on writing this paragraph till you understand it very clearly."

(a) The trainer asked the trainees going on writing that paragraph till they understood it very clearly.

(b) The trainer asked the trainees to go on writing that paragraph till they understood it very clearly.

(c) The trainer asked the trainees to go on writing that paragraph till they understand it very clearly.

(d) The trainer asked the trainees to went on writing that paragraph till they understood it very clearly.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

An imperative sentence expressing an instruction is converted using “asked/told + object + to + verb.” The pronoun “you” changes to “they,” and “this” changes to “that.”

Rule: Imperative in indirect speech = reporting verb + object + to-infinitive.

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

Q24. DIRECT SPEECH

Choose the most appropriate conversion into direct speech.

She said that she had started attending yoga classes because she wanted to lose weight.

(a) She said, "I started attending yoga classes because I wants to lose weight."

(b) She said, "I have started attending yoga classes because I want to lose weight."

(c) She said, "I started attending yoga classes because I wanted to lose weight."

(d) She said, "I had started attending yoga classes because I want lose weight."

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

In direct speech, “she” changes to “I.” The reported past perfect “had started” can revert to the present perfect “have started,” and “wanted” returns to “want” when the original present-tense intention is restored.

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

Q25. DIRECT SPEECH

Choose the most appropriate conversion into direct speech.

He asked her whether she wanted tea or coffee with her breakfast.

(a) He asked her, "You want tea or coffee with your breakfast?"

(b) He said, "Whether you want tea or coffee with your breakfast?"

(c) He asked, "Did you want tea or coffee with your breakfast?"

(d) He said to her, "Do you want tea or coffee with your breakfast?"

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✓ **Correct Answer: (d)**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

An indirect yes/no question introduced by “whether” is converted into a direct question using the auxiliary verb “do.” The question mark and quotation marks are used in direct speech.

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

DATE 9 October 2026

SSC CGL 2026 English Questions — 9 October 2026

Q1. ERROR CORRECTION — PHRASAL USAGE

Select the most appropriate option to replace the highlighted segment. If no replacement is required, choose “No substitution required.”

During the briefing on the new city-bus timetable, the conductor explained that the route comprises of three major interchanges and two feeder loops, so commuters should keep extra time for transfers.

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(a) comprises

(b) is comprised of

(c) comprising of

(d) No substitution required

Correct Answer: (a) comprises

EXPLANATION

The verb comprise means “to consist of” or “to include.” It is not followed by “of” in standard usage.

Corrected sentence: The conductor explained that the route comprises three major interchanges and two feeder loops.

EXAM TIP Use “comprises three parts” or “consists of three parts.”

Topic: Grammar — Correct Usage

Q2.

SPELLING

Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) Perseverance

(b) Ameliarate

(c) Conscience

(d) Magnanimity

Correct Answer: (b) Ameliarate

EXPLANATION

The correct spelling is ameliorate, meaning to improve something or make a bad situation better.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Perseverance — continued effort despite difficulties

Conscience — an inner sense of right and wrong

Magnanimity — generosity and forgiveness

Ameliorate — to improve

Topic: Spelling

Q3.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTION

Select the most appropriate word for:

“Evoking a keen sense of sadness or regret.”

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(a) Pungent

(b) Poignant

(c) Impactful

(d) Unaffecting

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Poignant**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Poignant describes something deeply moving that evokes sadness, sympathy, or regret.

EXAMPLE

Example: The film tells a poignant story of separation and sacrifice.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Poignant — deeply moving or emotionally touching

Pungent — having a strong smell or sharp quality

Impactful — having a strong effect

Unaffecting — failing to move or impress

Topic: Vocabulary

Q4.

PHRASAL VERBS

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate phrase.

They _____ the table beautifully for their guests.

(a) laid in

(b) laid out

(c) laid by

(d) laid on

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) laid out**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Lay out means to arrange or display something neatly. Here, it refers to arranging the table for a meal.

EXAMPLE

Example: They laid out the plates, glasses, and cutlery before dinner.

Topic: Phrasal Verbs

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Q5.

TENSES

Choose the best option to fill in the blank.

Both Amia and Kavitha _____ hard for their Bank PO exams scheduled next month.

(a) study

(b) have been studying

(c) has been studying

(d) is studying

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) have been studying**

✦ EXPLANATION

The present perfect continuous tense describes an activity that began in the past and continues into the present.

"Both Amia and Kavitha" refers to two people, so the plural auxiliary have is required.

Rule: Subject + have/has + been + verb-ing.

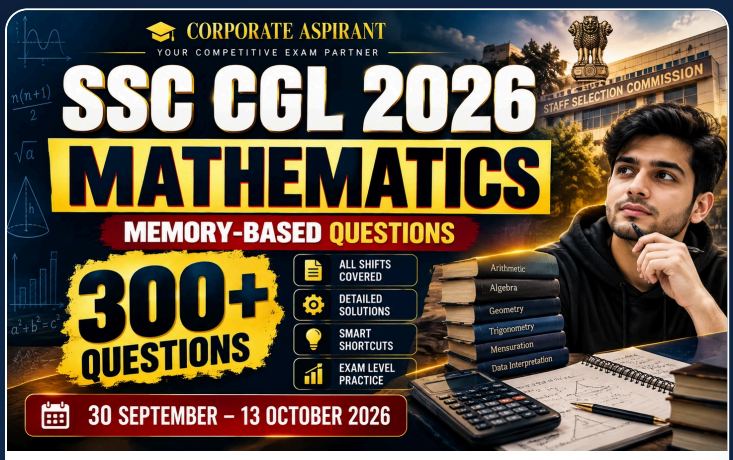
Topic: Tenses and Subject-Verb Agreement

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Q6. IDIOM

Which idiom means taking advantage of rules, procedures, or structures to achieve a personal or institutional goal, sometimes by exploiting loopholes?

(a) Buck the system

(b) Get something out of one's system

(c) Get something out of your system

(d) Work the system

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) Work the system**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Work the system means using an existing system strategically to achieve a desired outcome, sometimes by exploiting its loopholes.

Related Idioms:

Buck the system — resist or challenge established rules

Get something out of your system — do something to relieve a strong urge or emotion

Work the system — use the system to one's advantage

Topic: Idioms and Phrases

Q7. SYNONYM

Find the word most nearly similar in meaning to ENERVATE.

(a) Candid

(b) Judicious

(c) Debilitate

(d) Invigorate

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) Debilitate**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Enervate means to weaken or drain someone of energy. Debilitate has a similar meaning.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Enervate — weaken or exhaust

Debilitate — make weak

Invigorate — energise or strengthen

Judicious — showing good judgment

Candid — honest and straightforward

Topic: Synonyms

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Q8. ERROR SPOTTING

Select the part of the sentence that contains a grammatical error.

She admitted to have disclosed fragments of the cipher (A) / while insisting that her doing so (B) / served merely as a decoy (C) / for the auditors prowling the corridor (D).

(a) A

(b) B

(c) C

(d) D

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) A**

✦ EXPLANATION

The expression "admitted to" is followed by a noun or a gerund, not a to-infinitive.

Corrected sentence: She admitted to having disclosed fragments of the cipher while insisting that her doing so served merely as a decoy for the auditors prowling the corridor.

Rule: Admit to + noun/verb-ing.

Topic: Error Spotting — Gerunds

Q9. PARA JUMBLES

Arrange the following parts in the correct order.

The Employees' Provident Fund began as a wartime expedient.

P. That original purpose has long since been overtaken.

Q. Industrial workers were leaving their jobs in large numbers, and a compulsory saving was devised to hold them in place.

R. What was designed as an instrument of labour retention has become the principal vehicle of retirement security for the organised workforce.

S. Retention was therefore the object; old-age security was, at best, an incidental benefit.

Institutions, it seems, are frequently better remembered for what they became than for what they were meant to be.

(a) Q S P R

(b) S Q R P

(c) P Q S R

(d) R S Q P

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Q S P R**

✦ EXPLANATION

Q explains why the fund was introduced. S clarifies its original purpose, P contrasts that purpose with its later

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Topic: Para Jumbles

Q10. SYNONYM

Select the most appropriate synonym of TRANSIENT.

(a) Transparent

(b) Permanent

(c) Temporary

(d) Truthful

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✓ **Correct Answer: (c) Temporary**

✦ EXPLANATION

Transient means lasting only for a short time. Temporary is its closest synonym.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Transient — short-lived

Ephemeral — lasting for a very short time

Permanent — lasting indefinitely

Fleeting — passing quickly

Topic: Synonyms

Q11. COMMONLY CONFUSED WORDS

Choose the correct word to complete the sentence.

The soldiers had to _____ the heavy load up the hill.

(a) Bare

(b) Bear

(c) Bier

(d) Beer

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Bear**

✦ EXPLANATION

Bear means to carry, support, or endure a burden. It fits the sentence because the soldiers must carry a heavy load.

Remember the difference:

Bear — carry or endure

Bare — uncovered or exposed

Bier — a stand used to carry a coffin

Beer — an alcoholic beverage

Topic: Commonly Confused Words

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Q12. PASSIVE VOICE

Select the correct passive voice.

The strong current of the river broke through the wall of the earthen dam within no time.

(a) The wall of the earthen dam was broken within no time by the strong current of the river.

(b) The wall of the earthen dam was broken through within no time by the strong current of the river.

(c) The wall of the earthen dam had broken through within no time by the strong current of the river.

(d) The wall of the earthen dam had been broken through within no time by the strong current of the river.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The active verb "broke through" is in the simple past tense. In the passive construction, it becomes "was broken through."

Rule: Simple past passive = was/were + past participle.

Topic: Active and Passive Voice

Q13. ACTIVE VOICE

Select the correct active form.

"Such mistakes are not expected to be made by trained professionals."

(a) Trained professionals are not making such mistakes.

(b) Trained professionals are not expected to make such mistakes.

(c) Trained professionals should not have made such mistakes.

(d) Trained professionals avoid such mistakes.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b)**

✦ EXPLANATION

In the passive sentence, "mistakes" is the subject. In the active form, "trained professionals" becomes the subject, and "to be made" changes to "to make."

Correct sentence: Trained professionals are not expected to make such mistakes.

Topic: Active and Passive Voice

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Cloze Test

Directions: Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate word for each blank.

The judiciary, as the institutional custodian of constitutional rectitude, occupies a position of singular consequence in any polity governed by the supremacy of law. Its legitimacy, however, does not derive exclusively from the coercive authority vested in judicial pronouncements, but from the perceived impartiality, doctrinal consistency, and procedural probity with which disputes are adjudicated. When courts are confronted with executive encroachments or legislative measures ostensibly inimical to fundamental rights, their obligation is to scrutinise such actions with dispassionate exactitude, lest constitutional guarantees become merely (1) _____ assurances devoid of enforceable substance.

Nevertheless, judicial intervention must not degenerate into institutional overreach, whereby unelected adjudicators (2) _____ the prerogatives constitutionally entrusted to the legislature or executive. The doctrine of separation of powers, therefore, necessitates a calibrated equilibrium between judicial restraint and constitutional vigilance. Moreover, the protracted pendency of litigation, compounded by procedural (3) _____ and inadequate adjudicatory infrastructure, threatens to render the promise of expeditious justice illusory. Such systemic deficiencies disproportionately afflict indigent litigants, for (4) _____ the cost of protracted litigation may prove prohibitive, thereby perpetuating structural inequities under the guise of formal equality. Ultimately, public confidence in the judicial apparatus depends upon its capacity to dispense justice without fear or favour, while ensuring that legal formalism does not (5) _____ substantive fairness. An independent judiciary, accordingly, must remain both institutionally autonomous and scrupulously accountable to the constitutional ethos it is constituted to uphold.

Q14. BLANK 1

(a) Nugatory

(b) Inviolable

(c) Sacrosanct

(d) Immutable

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Nugatory**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Nugatory means having no value or effect. The sentence suggests that constitutional guarantees would become meaningless if they could not be enforced.

VOCABULARY:

Nugatory — ineffective or worthless

Inviolable — that must not be violated

Sacrosanct — regarded as too important to be interfered with

Immutable — unchanging

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Q15. BLANK 2

(a) Usurp

(b) Abrogate

(c) Repudiate

(d) Circumscribe

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Usurp**

CORPORATE ASPIRANT

✦ EXPLANATION

Usurp means to take power, authority, or a position without the right to do so. The sentence warns against judges taking over powers constitutionally assigned to other branches of government.

VOCABULARY:

Usurp — seize authority unlawfully

Abrogate — formally abolish

Repudiate — reject or refuse to accept

Circumscribe — restrict or limit

Q16. BLANK 3

(a) Obfuscation

(b) Dilatoriness

(c) Intransigence

(d) Equivocation

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Dilatoriness**

CORPORATE ASPIRANT

✦ EXPLANATION

Dilatoriness means slowness or a tendency to delay. It fits the discussion of prolonged litigation and delayed justice.

VOCABULARY:

Dilatoriness — delay or slowness

Obfuscation — making something unclear

Intransigence — refusal to compromise

Equivocation — deliberately ambiguous language

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Q17. BLANK 4

(a) Whom

(b) Which

(c) Whose

(d) Whoever

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Whom**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

"For whom" refers to indigent litigants who may find the cost of prolonged litigation prohibitive. The pronoun functions as the object of the preposition "for."

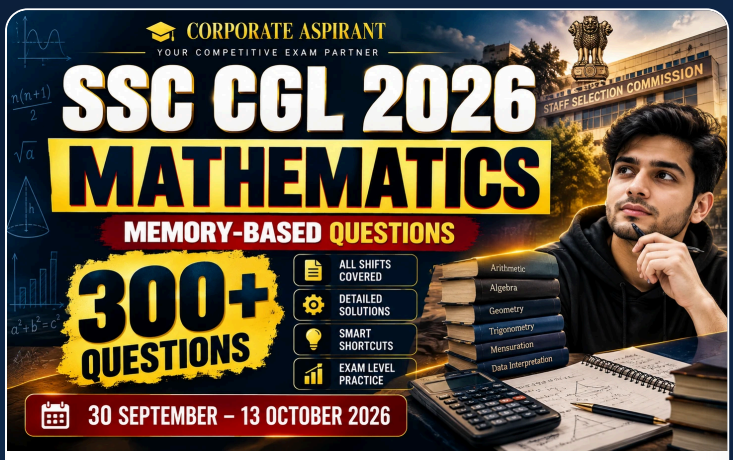
Grammar Tip: Use "whom" when referring to a person who is the object of a verb or preposition.

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Q18. BLANK 5

(a) Obviate

(b) Vitiate

(c) Vindicate

(d) Ameliorate

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Vitiate**

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✦ EXPLANATION

Vitiate means to impair, weaken, or spoil something. The sentence argues that legal formalities should not undermine substantive fairness.

VOCABULARY:

Vitiate — impair or undermine

Obviate — remove a difficulty or need

Vindicate — clear from blame or justify

Ameliorate — improve

Topic: Cloze Test and Advanced Vocabulary

Q19. PARA JUMBLES

Rearrange the sentences to form a meaningful and grammatically correct paragraph.

P. A large-scale migration was triggered in 1848 by the discovery of gold in California.

Q. Prospectors from all over the world were drawn to the promise of immediate fortune.

R. Few of the "Forty-Niners" did become wealthy.

S. Towns and communities in the American West proliferated as a result of this migration.

(a) S, Q, R, P

(b) P, Q, S, R

(c) Q, P, R, S

(d) R, Q, P, S

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) P, Q, S, R**

✦ EXPLANATION

P introduces the California Gold Rush. Q explains how prospectors were attracted by the discovery, S describes the resulting growth of settlements, and R concludes by noting that only a few prospectors became wealthy.

Topic: Para Jumbles

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Q20. DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH

Select the correct indirect narration.

Sarthak said to Reyansh, "I believe that every single person deserves a second chance to make things right after making a mistake."

(a) Sarthak told Reyansh that he had believed that every single person deserved a second chance to make things right after making a mistake.

(b) Sarthak told Reyansh that he believes that every single person deserved a second chance to make things right after making a mistake.

(c) Sarthak told Reyansh that he believed that every single person deserving a second chance to make things right after making a mistake.

(d) Sarthak told Reyansh that he believed that every single person deserved a second chance to make things right after making a mistake.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (d)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The pronoun "I" changes to "he," "believe" changes to "believed," and "deserves" changes to "deserved" under the usual backshift rule for reported speech.

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

Q21. ERROR SPOTTING — QUESTION TAGS

Identify the segment containing a grammatical error.

The board, despite reiterating its commitment to humane restructuring, has not approved the proposed retrenchment pause, do they, given the present credit-watch outlook?

(a) The board, despite reiterating its commitment to humane restructuring,

(b) has not approved the proposed retrenchment pause,

(c) do they, given the present credit-watch outlook?

(d) No error

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✓ **Correct Answer: (c)**

✦ EXPLANATION

The question tag must agree with the auxiliary verb and subject of the main clause. Since the main clause uses "has not approved," the appropriate tag is "has it?"

Corrected sentence: The board, despite reiterating its commitment to humane restructuring, has not approved the proposed retrenchment pause, has it, given the present credit-watch outlook?

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Topic: Error Spotting — Question Tags

Q22.

IDIOM

Select the correct meaning of A BIGGER BANG FOR ONE'S BUCK.

(a) To begin to put forth more effort in some area

(b) To be very healthy

(c) To make money quickly or without effort, often through dishonest means

(d) Greater value for the amount of money one is spending

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✓ **Correct Answer: (d)**

✦ EXPLANATION

A bigger bang for one's buck means obtaining greater value, benefit, or results for the money spent.

EXAMPLE

Example: Comparing prices helps consumers get a bigger bang for their buck.

Topic: Idioms and Phrases

Q23.

ANTONYM

Select the most appropriate antonym of VENERATE.

(a) Honor

(b) Despise

(c) Respect

(d) Admire

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Despise**

✦ EXPLANATION

Venerate means to regard someone or something with deep respect. Despise means to regard someone or something with contempt.

RELATED VOCABULARY:

Venerate — deeply respect

Revere — regard with profound respect

Admire — regard with approval

Despise — regard with contempt

Topic: Antonyms

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Q24. GRAMMAR — CORRECT USAGE

Choose the most suitable option to replace the highlighted part.

She insisted me to take the medicine.

(a) that I take the medicine

(b) me that I take medicine

(c) me taking the medicine

(d) to take medicine by me

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) that I take the medicine**

✦ EXPLANATION

The verb insist is not normally followed by "someone to do something." Use "insist that + subject + base verb" or "insist on + verb-ing."

Correct sentence: She insisted that I take the medicine.

Alternative: She insisted on my taking the medicine.

Topic: Grammar — Verb Patterns

Q25. INDIRECT SPEECH

Choose the correct indirect narration.

Suhani said to the clerk, "I phoned the officer to sign this document, but he just passed it to you."

(a) Suhani told the clerk that she phoned the officer to sign that document, but he had just passed it to him.

(b) Suhani told the clerk that she had phoned the officer to sign that document, but he just passed it to him.

(c) Suhani told the clerk that she had phoned the officer to sign that document, but he had just passed it to him.

(d) Suhani told the clerk that she phoned the officer to sign that document, but he just passed it to him.

✓ **Correct Answer: (c)**

✦ EXPLANATION

"I" changes to "she," "this document" changes to "that document," and "you" changes to "him" because Suhani is speaking to the clerk. Under the usual backshift rule, "phoned" changes to "had phoned," and "just passed" changes to "had just passed."

Topic: Direct and Indirect Speech

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SSC CGL 2026 English Questions — 10 October 2026

Q1. **Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.**

The curator will have catalogued the entire bequest by June.

(a) The entire bequest will have been catalogued by the curator by June.

(b) The entire bequest would have been catalogued by the curator by June.

(c) The entire bequest will be catalogued by the curator by June.

(d) The entire bequest has been catalogued by the curator by June.

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) The entire bequest will have been catalogued by the curator by June.**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The sentence is in the future perfect tense. Its passive structure is:

Active: Subject + will have + V3 + Object

Passive: Object + will have been + V3 + by + Subject

Therefore, “will have catalogued” becomes “will have been catalogued.”

Q2. **Which word is most dissimilar in meaning to the given word?**

Pristine

(a) Primal

(b) Sullied

(c) Spacious

(d) Precious

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Sullied**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Pristine means pure, clean, or in its original, unspoiled condition. Sullied means stained, dirty, or tarnished. They have opposite meanings.

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Pristine — Pure, unspoiled | Sullied — Stained, tainted | Primal — Original, fundamental

Precious — Valuable, treasured

Q3. **Choose the word opposite in meaning to Virtue.**

(a) Vice

(b) Quality

(c) Wickedness

(d) Crime

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Vice**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Virtue refers to moral goodness or a commendable quality. Vice means immoral behaviour or a bad habit. Hence, "vice" is the direct antonym.

VOCABULARY:

Virtue — Moral goodness | Vice — Immoral behaviour | Wickedness — Evil or moral corruption

Q4. **Choose the most appropriate conversion into direct speech.**

He questioned whether they had really complied with the revised safety protocols.

(a) He asked, "Did they really complied with the revised safety protocols?"

(b) He said, "Did we really complied with the revised safety protocols?"

(c) He asked, "Had they comply with the revised safety protocols?"

(d) He asked, "Have they really complied with the revised safety protocols?"

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) He asked, "Have they really complied with the revised safety protocols?"**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

In indirect speech, "had complied" can correspond to the present perfect in the original direct question when the reporting verb is "questioned." The correct question form is Have + subject + V3?

The other options contain incorrect verb forms or an incorrect change of pronoun.

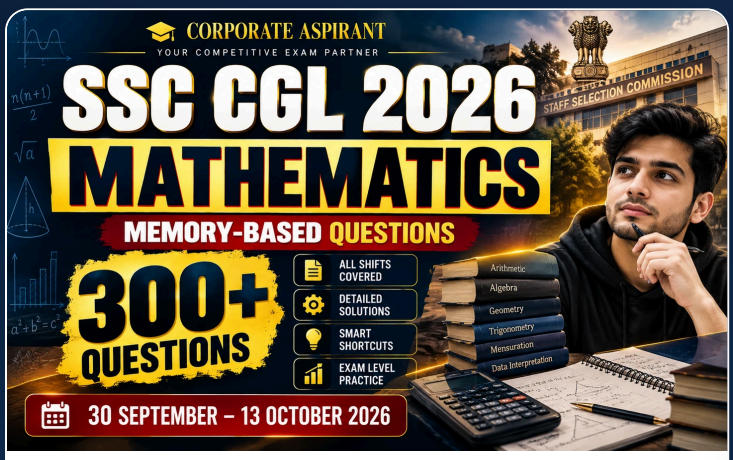
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Q5. **Choose the most appropriate conversion into direct speech.**

He said that he had been waiting there for his boss for over an hour.

(a) He said, "I have been waiting here for my boss for over an hour."

(b) He said, "I have waited there for his boss for over an hour."

(c) He said, "I had waited here for my boss for over an hour."

(d) He said, "I am waiting there for my boss for over an hour."

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✓ **Correct Answer: (a) He said, "I have been waiting here for my boss for over an hour."**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

When converting indirect speech back into direct speech, restore the original first-person pronoun and the appropriate time and place expressions.

He → I

There → here

His boss → my boss

Had been waiting → have been waiting

The present perfect continuous describes an action that began in the past and continued up to the relevant point.

Q6. **Rearrange the sentences to form a coherent paragraph.**

S1: Then, one day, she was up, playing; Isabel was in the kitchen fixing lunch for the two boys when they'd come in from school, and she heard Grace fall down in the living room.

A. And she ran to the living room and there was little Grace on the floor, all twisted up, and the reason she hadn't screamed was that she couldn't get her breath.

B. When you have a lot of children you don't always start running when one of them falls, unless they start screaming or something.

C. Yet, Isabel says that when she heard that thump and then that silence, something happened in her to make her afraid.

D. And, this time, Grace was quiet.

S2: And when she did scream, it was the worst sound, Isabel says, that she'd ever heard in all her life, and she still hears it sometimes in her dreams.

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(a) ADBC

(b) DCBA

(c) BDCA

(d) DCAB

✓ **Correct Answer: (c) BDCA**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The logical sequence is B → D → C → A.

B provides the general context about how a parent reacts when a child falls.

D introduces the unusual silence.

C explains Isabel's fear after hearing the thump and silence.

A describes her running to Grace and discovering her condition.

Thus, the correct sequence is BDCA.

Q7. **Select the option that expresses the sentence in passive voice.**

Who tampered with the records?

(a) Who were the records tampered with?

(b) By whom were the records tampered with?

(c) By whom the records were tampered?

(d) Whom were the records tampered by?

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) By whom were the records tampered with?**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The passive form of a question beginning with “Who” can be formed using “By whom.”

Active: Who tampered with the records?

Passive: By whom were the records tampered with?

The phrasal verb “tamper with” retains the preposition “with” in the passive construction.

Q8. **Choose the pair of words that most suitably fills the blanks.**

The new medication did not _____ the patient's symptoms as expected, so the doctor questioned its overall _____.

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(a) Alter, altar

(b) Altar, alter

(c) Effect, affect

(d) Affect, effect

Correct Answer: (d) Affect, effect

EXPLANATION

Affect is generally a verb meaning to influence or produce a change in something.

Effect is generally a noun meaning a result or outcome.

The medication did not affect the symptoms as expected, so the doctor questioned its overall effect.

Quick trick: Affect = Action (usually a verb); Effect = End result (usually a noun).

Q9. Select the most appropriate meaning of the idiom "Hoist with one's own petard."

(a) To be promoted far beyond one's competence

(b) To be rescued unexpectedly at the last moment

(c) To be burdened with another person's debts

(d) To be harmed or ruined by the very scheme one devised against another

Correct Answer: (d) To be harmed or ruined by one's own scheme.

EXPLANATION

The idiom means that a person is harmed by their own plan, trick, or attempt to harm someone else.

EXAMPLE

Example: The company tried to spread false rumours about its competitor but was exposed by its own leaked emails. It was hoist with its own petard.

Q10. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom "Straight from the horse's mouth."

(a) From an anonymous tip

(b) Hearing it from someone else

(c) Reading it from a book

(d) From a reliable source

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✦ EXPLANATION

The idiom means receiving information directly from the person who knows the facts or is directly involved.

EXAMPLE

Example: I heard the announcement straight from the horse's mouth.

Q11. **Convert the direct speech into indirect speech.**

The Minister of State said, "The government has resolved the farmers' issues amicably."

(a) The Minister of State said that the government had resolved the farmers' issues amicably.

(b) The Minister of State said that the government has resolved the farmers' issues amicably.

(c) The Minister of State said that the government resolves the farmers' issues amicably.

(d) The Minister of State said the farmers' issues were resolved amicably by the government.

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) The Minister of State said that the government had resolved the farmers' issues amicably.**

✦ EXPLANATION

When the reporting verb is in the past tense, the present perfect tense generally changes to the past perfect tense in reported speech.

Has resolved → Had resolved

The meaning of the original statement remains unchanged.

Q12. **Rearrange the following sentence parts to form a meaningful and grammatically correct paragraph.**

P. He created mockups of each screen the user would view in order to build the user interface.

Q. He programmed the app's features and response, writing the fundamental logic.

R. He fixed errors and made sure the app ran well by testing it on a variety of devices.

S. He made the finished product available for download by uploading it to the app store.

(a) R, Q, P, S

(b) Q, P, R, S

(c) S, Q, R, P

(d) P, Q, R, S

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✦ EXPLANATION

The sentences describe the stages of app development in chronological order:

P: Create screen mockups and plan the user interface.

Q: Program the app's features and logic.

R: Test the app and fix errors.

S: Upload the completed app to the app store.

Therefore, the correct sequence is PQRS.

Q13. **Choose the part of the sentence that contains an error.**

When asked why students had enrolled in the geometry class, 85% of them saw it as essentials.

(a) When asked why students had enrolled

(b) in the geometry class,

(c) 85% of them saw it as essentials.

(d) No correction required

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✓ **Correct Answer: (c) 85% of them saw it as essentials.**

✦ EXPLANATION

"Essentials" is a plural noun, whereas the sentence requires an adjective describing how the students viewed the geometry class.

Correct sentence: When asked why students had enrolled in the geometry class, 85% of them saw it as essential.

Rule: Use an adjective after "saw it as" when describing the nature or importance of something.

Q14. **Identify the segment containing a grammatical error.**

No sooner had the verdict been announced when the defence counsel rose to file an appeal.

(a) No sooner had the verdict been announced

(b) when the defence counsel

(c) rose to file

(d) an appeal

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) when the defence counsel**

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✦ EXPLANATION

"No sooner" is paired with "than," not "when."

Correct sentence: No sooner had the verdict been announced than the defence counsel rose to file an appeal.

EXAM RULE

No sooner ... than

Hardly ... when

Scarcely ... when

Q15. **Rearrange the sentences to form a coherent paragraph.**

S1: One day, as he was walking about beneath the tree, he saw several young snakes coming out of a hole in the ground.

A. I left you starving, and now here you are, well and strong!

B. When they grew strong and began to move about in the jungle, they met their mother, who exclaimed: "I can't believe it!"

C. The herdsman felt sorry for them, so every day he gave them some milk.

D. They looked thin and miserable.

S2: They told her how the herdsman had taken care of them.

(a) DCBA

(b) CDAB

(c) BDCA

(d) ACBD

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) DCBA**

✦ EXPLANATION

The sequence follows the events in the story:

D: The young snakes looked thin and miserable.

C: The herdsman began feeding them milk.

B: They grew strong and later met their mother.

A: Their mother reacted to their improved condition.

Therefore, the correct sequence is DCBA

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Q16. **Rearrange the sentences to form a coherent paragraph.**

S1: Although he was married, with children, his was a solitary disposition; he liked best to work alone.

A. Autumn was best for this, better than spring.

B. It pleased him when he was given a bank to build up or a gate to mend at the far end of the peninsula, where the sea surrounded the farmland on either side.

C. Then, at midday, he would pause and eat the pasty that his wife had baked for him and, sitting on the cliff's edge, would watch the birds.

D. In spring the birds flew inland, purposeful, intent; they knew where they were bound; the rhythm and ritual of their life brooked no delay.

S2: In autumn those that had not migrated overseas but remained to pass the winter were caught up in the same driving urge, but because migration was denied them, followed a pattern of their own.

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(a) BCAD

(b) BACD

(c) ACDB

(d) CDAB

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) BCAD**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The sequence is B → C → A → D.

B describes the man's solitary outdoor work.

C continues with what he did at midday.

A introduces autumn as the best season for this activity.

D contrasts spring with autumn, leading naturally to S2's discussion of autumn birds.

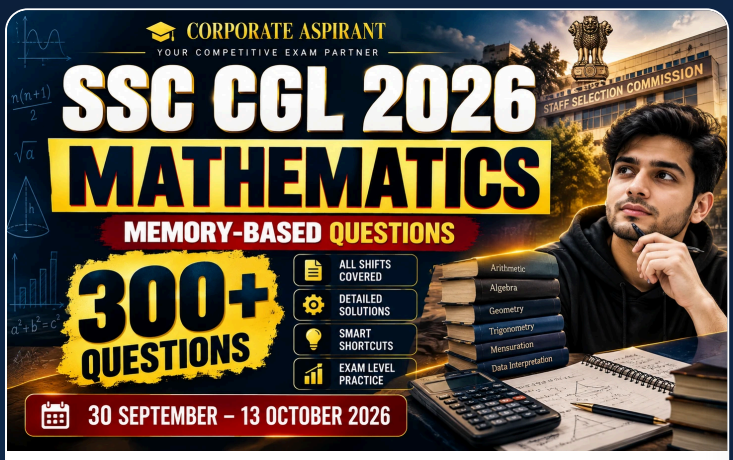
Thus, the correct sequence is BCAD.

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Q17. **What is the antonym of Egalitarian?**

(a) Fair

(b) Biased

(c) Democratic

(d) Equitable

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Biased**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

Egalitarian describes a person, belief, or system that supports equality among people. Biased means favouring one person or group unfairly over another.

VOCABULARY:

Egalitarian — Supporting equality

Biased — Prejudiced or unfairly partial

Equitable — Fair and impartial

Democratic — Based on equality and participation

Cloze Test

Read the passage and choose the most appropriate option for each blank.

The handloom has outlived every technology that was supposed to bury it. Each generation of mill owners has confidently announced its (1) _____, and each has been obliged to watch the loom persist in villages where capital never quite arrived. Part of the explanation is economic: a loom costs little, occupies the corner of a house, and can be (2) _____ by a family without wages, supervisors or shift timings. But economics alone cannot account for the stubbornness of the craft. A handwoven sari carries irregularities — a thickened weft here, a wandering border there — that a power loom is engineered to eliminate, and urban buyers have lately begun to (3) _____ precisely those flaws as proof of human authorship. What the mill treats as defect, the market has learnt to read as signature.

Policy, meanwhile, has been rather less helpful than its budgets would suggest. Schemes conceived in distant capitals tend to (4) _____ weavers as beneficiaries rather than as entrepreneurs, dispensing subsidies while leaving the architecture of debt and middlemen wholly untouched. The weavers' own associations argue, with some justice, that what the trade needs is not charity but access — to yarn at fair prices, to contemporary design, and above all to the buyer, from whom they remain (5) _____ by a chain of intermediaries who capture most of the margin.

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Q18. **(a) Inception**

(b) Demise

(c) Resurgence

(d) Decree

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Demise**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Demise means death, termination, or the end of something. The sentence indicates that mill owners repeatedly predicted the end of the handloom industry.

VOCABULARY:

Inception — Beginning

Demise — End or termination

Resurgence — Revival or renewed growth

Decree — An official order

Q19. **(a) Plied**

(b) Levied

(c) Hewn

(d) Forged

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Plied**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Ply can mean to work at or operate something regularly. In the passage, the intended meaning is that a family can operate the loom without needing paid workers or formal shift arrangements.

VOCABULARY:

Ply — To work at or operate regularly

Levy — To impose a tax or charge

Hew — To cut or shape using a tool

Forge — To shape metal or create something through effort

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Q20. **(a) Deplore**

(b) Forfeit

(c) Mimic

(d) Prize

✓ **Correct Answer: (d) Prize**

✦ EXPLANATION

Prize means to value or appreciate something highly. The passage explains that buyers have begun to value the irregularities in handwoven saris as evidence of human craftsmanship.

VOCABULARY:

Deplore — To strongly disapprove of

Forfeit — To lose or surrender

Mimic — To imitate

Prize — To value highly

Q21. **(a) Cast**

(b) Enlist

(c) Absolve

(d) Nominate

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) Cast**

✦ EXPLANATION

The expression “cast someone as” means to present or portray someone in a particular role. The sentence criticises schemes that portray weavers as beneficiaries rather than entrepreneurs.

EXAMPLE

Example: The policy casts small businesses as passive recipients of aid.

Q22. **(a) Inoculated**

(b) Insulated

(c) Instigated

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✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Insulated**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Insulated from means separated or protected from direct contact with something. Here, weavers remain separated from buyers by intermediaries who capture most of the profit.

VOCABULARY:

Inoculated — Given protection against a disease or harmful influence

Insulated — Separated or shielded

Instigated — Provoked or initiated

Inculcated — Impressed an idea through repeated instruction

Q23. **Select the most appropriate synonym of Ebullient.**

(a) Depressed

(b) Joyful

(c) Melancholy

(d) Gloomy

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Joyful**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

Ebullient means enthusiastic, energetic, and full of excitement or happiness.

VOCABULARY:

Ebullient — Cheerful and enthusiastic

Depressed — Feeling low or sad

Melancholy — Deep sadness

Gloomy — Dark, sad, or pessimistic

Q24. **Identify the incorrect sentence.**

(a) Mitali's hair is long and black.

(b) Either of the alternatives seem to present major difficulties.

(c) One of the cars in the garage is fifty years old.

(d) Sharon has six brothers.

✓ **Correct Answer: (b) Either of the alternatives seem to present major difficulties.**

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✦ **EXPLANATION**

"Either" is treated as singular in standard subject–verb agreement. Therefore, it takes the singular verb "seems," not "seem."

Correct sentence: Either of the alternatives seems to present major difficulties.

EXAM RULE Indefinite pronouns such as either, neither, each, and everyone generally take singular verbs when used as the subject.

Q25. **Arrange the following sentences in the correct sequence to form a coherent paragraph.**

A. Sleep, long regarded as a passive interval between useful hours, is now understood as a period of intense metabolic housekeeping.

B. The implication is uncomfortable for a culture that treats sleeplessness as a badge of industry.

C. During it, the brain flushes out proteins whose accumulation is associated with degenerative disease.

D. Deprivation, therefore, is not merely tiring; it is corrosive.

(a) A-C-D-B

(b) A-D-C-B

(c) C-A-D-B

(d) A-B-C-D

✓ **Correct Answer: (a) A-C-D-B**

✦ **EXPLANATION**

The paragraph develops its argument in a logical sequence:

A: Introduces the modern understanding of sleep.

C: Explains one important function of sleep.

D: Draws a conclusion about the harmful effects of sleep deprivation.

B: Explains the broader cultural implication of this conclusion.

Therefore, the correct sequence is A-C-D-B.

✦ Quick Revision: Important Vocabulary

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Pristine

Pure and unspoiled

Sullied

Stained or tarnished

Virtue

Moral goodness

Vice

Immoral behaviour

Hoist with one's own petard

Harmed by one's own scheme

Straight from the horse's mouth

Directly from a reliable source

Egalitarian

Supporting equality

Demise

End or termination

Deplore

Strongly disapprove of

Prize

Value highly

Insulated

Separated or shielded

Ebullient

Cheerful and enthusiastic

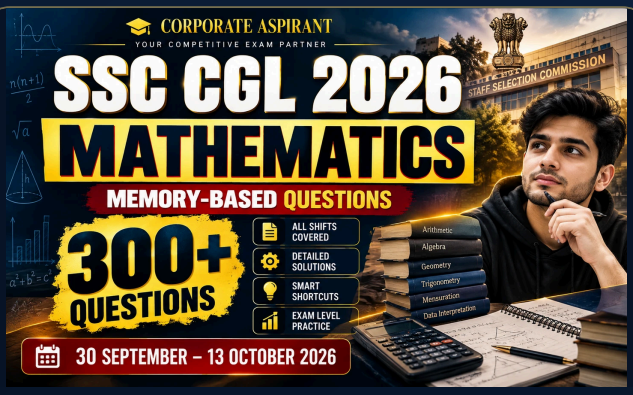
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